

Eden's Table

— Teacher's Guide —

A Biblical, Terrain-Based Herbalism Curriculum



36 Full Weeks

Sprouts K-2

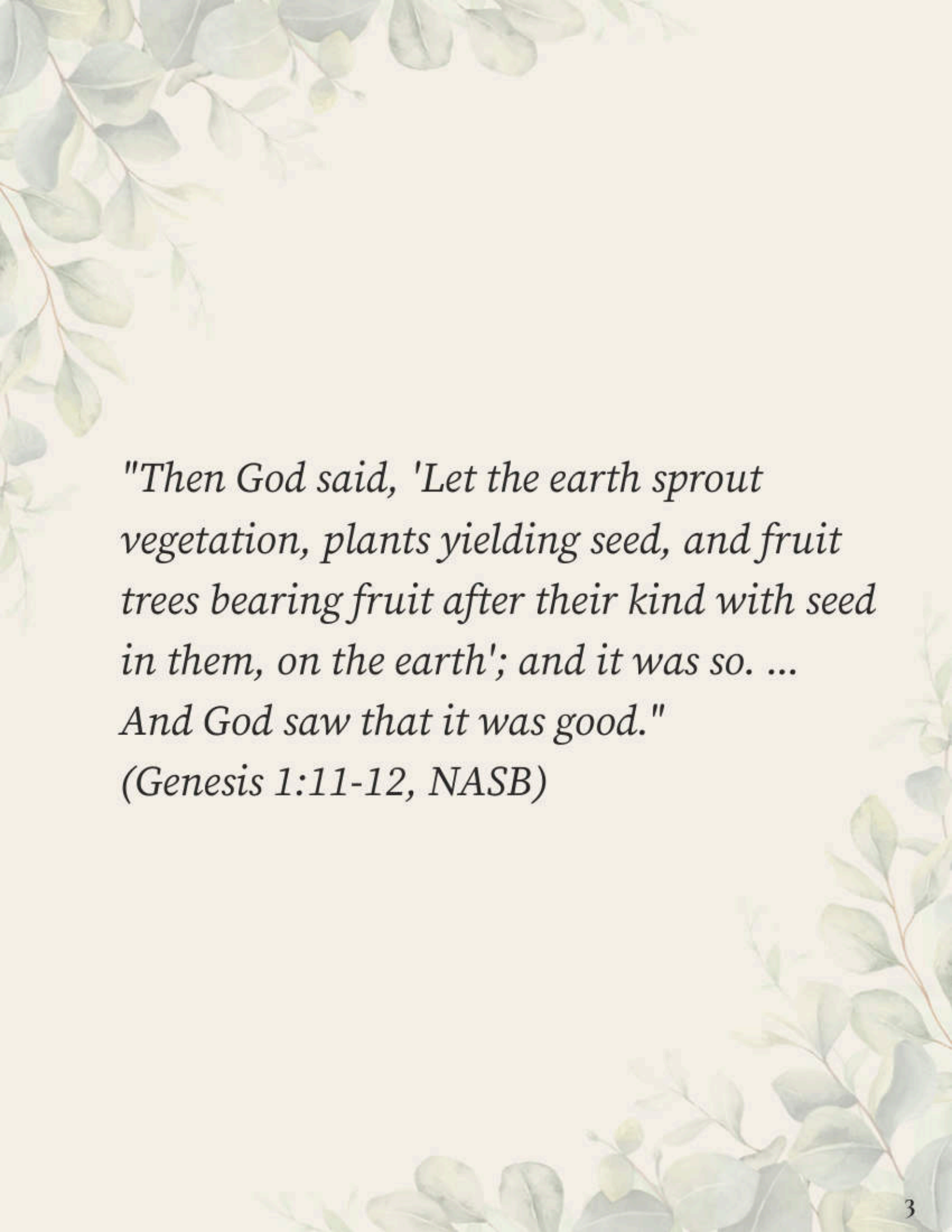
**An Eden Institute
Curriculum**

Eden's Table

*A Biblical, Terrain-Based Herbalism Curriculum
Sprouts Level · Teacher's Guide
A thirty-six-week year at the family table.*

Camila Johnson, M.Ed

*An Eden Institute curriculum, published by Rooted in
Faith Ventures LLC.
edeninstitute.health/homeschool*



*"Then God said, 'Let the earth sprout
vegetation, plants yielding seed, and fruit
trees bearing fruit after their kind with seed
in them, on the earth'; and it was so. ...
And God saw that it was good."
(Genesis 1:11-12, NASB)*

Before We Begin: Why I Wrote This

We live in an upside-down world.

Somewhere along the way, we handed our common sense and discernment to people we were told knew better. We learned to trust the white coat over our own gut. We sat across from someone who never asked how we were sleeping, whether we'd had enough water, or whether we'd moved our body that week, and watched them reach for a prescription pad instead. Then we were coached to call that normal, because surely anyone with that much schooling knows more than we do.

I want to challenge that. Not the schooling. The surrender.

The question I always get

Whenever I tell people I wrote a health and herbalism curriculum, the question comes fast: What qualifies you to do this?

So here's the plain answer. I'm a formally trained educator. I hold a master's in education, my undergraduate degree is in special education, and I spent twelve years teaching both special-needs and gifted children. For some people, that's the part that lets them exhale. Oh good, she's allowed to do this.

I understand why those letters bring comfort. But let me tell you the truth about them.

Where the real chops came from

The skill that actually made me a teacher wasn't earned in a seat as a student. It was earned standing in front of a room full of children, learning what works, learning what lands, learning each child one by one.

Because the hardest part of teaching, and starting over from zero every September, was never the content. It was building rapport. Rapport is the single most powerful thing a teacher can do, and everything else grows out of it.

I watched special-needs students outperform gifted students year after year for that one reason. My principal used to say those kids would "walk through a wall for Miss Oliveira," my maiden name. That wasn't my degree talking. That was trust. And once a child trusts you, the learning happens almost on its own.

Which brings me to you

There's a whole group of mothers who've quietly convinced themselves they aren't credentialed enough to teach their own children. Maybe someone even asked you outright: What gives you the right?

Let me say it as clearly as I can. Being their mom is the credential.

The rapport I spent twelve years learning to build with strangers' children, the bond that takes months of patient work, you already have. It was there the day they were born. No school granted it to you, and none can take it away. A child is wired to learn from the person who loves them most. You aren't under-qualified. You're the most qualified person in their life.

A word about the system, and the people in it

Many educators have pulled their own children out of school, because the system itself is broken. We hand our kids to adults who don't know them, and too often no one builds the rapport that makes learning possible.

But hear me clearly: this is not about blaming teachers. There are extraordinary, devoted teachers out there. The trouble is that the system has burnt them out and left them in survival mode, and you can't give a child your best when you have nothing left. That's not a character failure. It's a broken structure.

What it actually takes

Here's what no degree teaches: a truly good teacher runs on love and common sense.

And common sense applies straight to health. Herbs won't work if you aren't sleeping, aren't hydrating, aren't moving your body, and aren't spiritually aligned with God. Any program that leaves out the spiritual side of holistic health is doing you a disservice. So when a doctor skips every one of those questions and reaches straight for the prescription pad, I'll say it plainly: that isn't healthcare.

And yes, I've studied the plants themselves, course after course, more tuition than I'd care to admit. The irony? A culture this obsessed with credentials has none to offer here, no license, no recognized "certified herbalist" at all. And most of those courses still skipped the very thing that matters most: the soul of health.

Keeping a body well and resilient against chronic disease doesn't take decades of postgraduate study. It takes the basics, done faithfully: eat well, move your body, commune with God. Acute illness is its own conversation, and a real one. But the chronic-disease epidemic crushing this generation grows from something simpler and sadder: the chronic suppression of acute symptoms leads to chronic disease.

That's why this curriculum is built on the five tenets of health. They are the foundation. Herbs will never work if we use them the way this country uses medicine, as a quick silencer for symptoms we never bothered to understand.



What this is really for

My goal is bigger than any single lesson. It's to raise up a generation of children who see the entire healthcare industry through completely different eyes. (In the middle-school years we'll dig into how we got here, the real history behind it, but that's a story for another day.)

So if you're a mother holding this book and wondering whether you're enough to teach it, let me put that question to rest. By every formal measure, I'm credentialed. But that's not what makes me qualified, and it's not what makes you qualified either.

You don't need an institution's permission to teach your child. Most of this is common sense. Most of this is discernment. And most of all, it's simply getting back to Eden, and getting back to truth.

Let's begin.

How This Curriculum Works

A week at a glance. Each week centers on one herb and follows the same five-day rhythm, so children always know what comes next:

Monday, Read-Aloud. Open the week with the Scripture and, at seven points in the year, a story from the Read-Aloud Storybook. Discuss it together and begin the memory verse. (Bible, Language Arts, Character.)

Tuesday, Discovery. Observe the herb with all the senses, record it in the Nature Notebook, learn its Latin name, and meet the week's five new words. (Science, Art, Language Arts, Latin.)

Wednesday, Kitchen Lab. Make the week's one simple, same-day preparation, measuring and timing as you go. Bear, our kitchen-safety friend, reminds everyone of the rules. (Science, Math, Health.)

Thursday, History and Art. Travel to the herb's place and time, mark it on the map and the timeline, and make the week's art. (History, Geography, Art.)

Friday, Garden and Review. Do a hands-on garden or propagation activity, review the week, and recap the memory work. (Science, Math, Language Arts, Movement.)

Every week also carries its chant, its memory verse, and the herb's Latin name. (Music and Memory work.)

Five new words each week. Every week teaches five vocabulary words, one per day: a body word, an action word, a preparation word, a tradition word, and a propagation word. They never repeat across the year, and they are recorded in the Student Notebook.

The six units. The year moves through six units of six weeks each. See "The Six Units" on the next page, and the full Scope and Sequence in the back of this guide.

The six components, and how they fit together.

- *This Teacher's Guide holds the lessons, the safety guidance, and all the reference material.*
- *The Student Notebook is your child's own book for drawing, writing, and recording each week. One per child; additional copies are sold separately.*
- *The Read-Aloud Storybook holds six stories plus an opening, read at the weeks noted in the lessons.*
- *The Recipe Cards carry the week's kitchen preparation, one card per herb.*
- *The Field Cards teach plant recognition, one card per herb, for knowing plants by sight, never for gathering them.*
- *The Around the Table Cards offer conversation for the whole family.*

Before you make anything, read the safety pages. The Medical Disclaimer and the Herb Safety and Responsible Use pages in the back of this guide are not optional reading. We use herbs purchased from a reputable source or grown in our own garden, never wild-found plants, and we treat every preparation, by mouth or on the skin, with care. Sourcing links to Mountain Rose Herbs and Amazon appear throughout; an affiliate disclosure is in the back matter.

Time, ages, and pace. Sprouts is written for early elementary, roughly kindergarten through second grade, and is gentle enough to stretch across multiple ages at one table. Plan a short, unhurried session each day. If a week needs two, take two. This is a feast, not a race.

The Six Units

Unit 1, Design (Weeks 1-6). The body and the plant, wonderfully made. We begin in the garden and learn to see design on purpose.

Unit 2, Signals (Weeks 7-12). The body speaks. We learn to read its gentle signals rather than silence them.

Unit 3, Tenets (Weeks 13-18). The foundations of a healthy day: food, water, movement, rest, and connection with God, with the breath as the door.

Unit 4, Lineage (Weeks 19-24). The long heritage of herbal knowledge, including the herbs of Scripture and the monastery garden.

Unit 5, Constitution (Weeks 25-30). Each person is uniquely made. We learn that families and bodies come in patterns.

Unit 6, Practice (Weeks 31-36). Putting it all to work, as the learner becomes a helper at the family table.

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Lavender, for calm and the senses



I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

Psalm 139:14

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read "Meet the Family" – the Eden family's homestead; meet lavender's calm.
- TUESDAY** Lavender discovery – smell, look, sketch the spike
- WEDNESDAY** Brew lavender tea – measure, steep, taste
- THURSDAY** Roman baths – draw lavender by Roman arches
- FRIDAY** Explore the living garden; wrap up the week together

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

Lavender helps you feel calm, but God made your body to rest on its own. What does your body feel like when it is ready to sleep?

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried lavender buds
- Hot water
- Mug
- Honey
- Cloth square + tie



Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Read-Aloud & Discussion

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lavender

Foundations • Calm & Senses

STORY ORIENTATION

This week we begin our whole year with a story. Read "Meet the Family" aloud together, and meet the Eden family: Vovó and PopPop on their Tennessee homestead, Levi and Ruthie, big-hearted Manny, gentle Evie, fiery little Gracie, and Bear, the goofy dog who knocks something over every week. All year this family will learn the way we will, at the kitchen table and out in the garden, where God has already tucked everything our bodies need. Our whole first unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at two of His gifts: the garden bursting with life, and the wonderful body He gave you. Our herb this week is lavender, a calm, sweet-smelling flower people have used to help tired bodies rest for hundreds of years. As your child listens, notice how Vovó pays attention, to people, to plants, to the smallest things, the very way we will learn all year. Wonder together: what might God want to teach us this year about the wonderful bodies He made?

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you a body that needs rest, and gave lavender a calm scent to quiet it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Which of the Eden family would you most like to meet, and why?
2. Vovó calls the garden and the table "the whole school" – what will we learn there?
3. I wonder – God made every part of you on purpose; which part makes you curious?

MEMORY VERSE

I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them smell the dried buds, then a fresh sprig, and say which is stronger. Tuck one behind an ear. Just smell and compare.

OLDER SPROUTS

Have them rub a lavender bud and a fresh sprig, then explain why drying makes the scent stronger.

TODAY'S WORD:

SENSES – the ways our body takes in the world: sight, smell, hearing, taste, and touch.

How woven –

Bible: the memory verse, Psalm 139:14, that you are wonderfully made;

Language Arts: your child meets the Eden family and learns to name them and retell who is who;

Character: attention – like Vovó, we learn to notice people and small things with care. Lavender greets us first through the senses, with its calm, sweet smell – a gift to a body God made to know His world.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading)•R3 – retell "Meet the Family," who is who

ELA (Speaking)•R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lavender

Foundations - Calm & Senses

DISCOVERY LESSON

Breathe in slowly, the way a naturalist would: that clean calm is lavender. Set a few dried buds in your child's palm. Look first: lavender climbs on tall, slender spikes, and every tiny flower is purple. Roll one bud between two fingers and breathe in – that soft, clean scent is its gift. Then feel the narrow, gray-green leaves, a little dry and rough, the way plants of sunny, rocky hillsides often are. Ask your child to tell back what each sense found, in their own words; there is no wrong answer, only careful looking. The same God who folded that scent into so small a flower made the very nose that breathes it in.

CORE QUESTION:

What does your nose notice first when you rub a lavender bud?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Look: find lavender's purple spikes and gray-green leaves.
 2. Rub: roll one bud between two fingers.
 3. Smell: breathe in slow – does your body settle?
 4. Name it: lavender's scent supports calm and rest.
 5. Say today's word, RELAXING – helps the body let go and rest.
- Little Sprouts: just smell, and say soft or strong.
Older Sprouts: tell why lavender helps a tired body rest.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a lavender spike; label the purple flowers and stem.
Say it: *Lavandula angustifolia* – from lavare, 'to wash'.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

RELAXING – eases tension so the body can settle and rest.

How woven –

Science: observing scent, color, and spike shape;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

Latin: its name, Lavandula.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe lavender's purple spikes and calming scent

Science-R3 – find where lavender hides its calming scent, in the flowers

Art-R3 – sketch and label a lavender spike

Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Lavandula angustifolia*

Kitchen Lab

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made · Pillar 1

Lavender

Foundations · Calm & Senses

KITCHEN LAB

Today is our first Kitchen Lab, and we are making lavender tea. Grown-ups call a tea made from flowers or leaves an infusion – it just means soaking them in hot water to draw out scent and flavor. So 'infusion' and 'tea' are the same thing! We will also tie a few dried buds into a little cloth sachet. One prep, made and enjoyed today.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab: brew and taste today; we never save it. Hot water is hot – a grown-up always pours it and lets the tea cool before your child sips.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried lavender buds into a mug.
 2. Pour 8 oz of hot water over the buds.
 3. Cover and steep 5 minutes – count them together.
 4. Strain out the buds.
 5. Stir in a little honey if you like; cool, then taste.
 6. For the sachet: spoon dried buds onto a cloth square and tie it shut.
- Little Sprouts: measure the lavender buds and breathe in their calm smell before the water is poured.
- Older Sprouts: watch the clock for the 5-minute steep, then strain out the buds by yourself.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: A little lavender goes far! We smell and touch the dried buds, but lavender essential oil is very strong – never taste it.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Science · Math · Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

SACHET – a small cloth bag of dried herbs that scents the air.

How woven –

Science: hot water draws the scent and flavor out of the dried buds;

Math: measure 1 teaspoon and count 5 steep-minutes;

Health: warm tea and slow breathing help the body rest.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – watch hot water draw lavender's scent into an infusion

Math-R3 – measure 1 tsp and time a 5-minute steep

Health-R2 – a grown-up pours the hot water

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "sachet"

History & Art

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lavender

Foundations - Calm & Senses

HISTORY LESSON

In ancient Rome, the public baths steamed with the fresh scent of lavender. The Romans loved to be clean, and they tucked lavender into their bathwater and even their laundry, so their skin and clothes carried its fresh, calming scent. They loved it so much that the plant's very name remembers it: 'lavender' is said to come from the Latin word lavare, which means 'to wash.' Every time we say its name, we speak a little Latin from two thousand years ago! Long before anyone could explain why a calming, cleansing plant was good for tired bodies, the gift was already growing on the sunny hillsides, waiting in the garden for the Romans.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

God made every plant on Creation's third day (Genesis 1:11-12). About 2,000 years ago the Romans pinned lavender to history, scenting their baths and laundry with it; its name is traditionally traced to lavare - 'to wash.'

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw three tall lavender stems rising up your page.
2. Climb each stem with rows of tiny purple flowers.
3. Color the slender leaves a soft gray-green.
4. Behind them, add Roman arches and columns.
5. Title it 'Lavender in Rome' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find the Mediterranean Sea and Italy on the map. Lavender loves the warm, sunny, rocky hills of this seaside land.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

LAVARE – the Latin word for 'to wash,' the root of the name 'lavender.'

How woven –

*History: the Romans and their scented baths;
Geography: finding the Mediterranean and Italy;*

*Art: a Roman-arch lavender drawing;
Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.*

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

*History-R2 – retell how the Romans scented their baths with lavender
Geography-R2 – locate the Mediterranean Sea and Italy
Art-R3 – draw lavender among Roman arches
ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "lavare"*

Garden & Review

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made · Pillar 1

Lavender

Foundations · Calm & Senses

GARDEN ACTIVITY

A GARDEN IS ALIVE. Stand still in a garden for a minute and you will find it is not still at all. God did not fill His garden with dead, unmoving things; He packed it with life, from the tallest sunflower to the tiniest ant. Leaves drink sunlight, worms tunnel the soil, bees hum flower to flower, and roots sip water underground. This first unit we slow down to wonder at all that God-made busyness.

DO: Visit a garden, yard, or windowsill plant and find three living things, maybe a leaf, a bug, and a worm. Look closely, then tell each one out loud, "You are alive!"

Little Sprouts: find one living thing and name it.

Older Sprouts: draw your three and tell what each was doing.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: chamomile – a tiny daisy flower that brings calm and grows so easily.

WEEK REVIEW

1. How does lavender's calm scent help the body God gave you?
2. You smelled, brewed, and grew lavender. Which did you like best?
3. Lavender made its scent before anyone knew why. What does that make you wonder about God?
4. This week you found the garden full of life. What living thing will you thank God for?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Psalm 139:14

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

"God gave us the scent of rest so we would remember to be still." –

Vovó

Today's threads: Science · Language Arts · Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

ALIVE – living and growing, not still or dead.

How woven –

Science: hunting for the living things in the garden;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Psalm 139:14 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

Grieve, A Modern Herbal (1931), 'Lavenders' · POWO, *Lavandula angustifolia* (Kew) · NCCIH, *Lavender* · NASB Psalm 139:13–14

FURTHER READING

Roots, Shoots, Buckets & Boots – Sharon Lovejoy (family read)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – find that a garden is full of living things

Math-R2 – count the living things you find

ELA-R2 – answer the week's four review questions

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Chamomile, for soothed skin and calm



I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

Genesis 1:29

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read "Life Force" – Gracie's cut heals by God's design; meet chamomile.
- TUESDAY** Chamomile discovery – look close, sketch the daisy
- WEDNESDAY** Steep chamomile flowers – count 5 min, taste
- THURSDAY** Egypt's Nile – paint chamomile suns
- FRIDAY** Look close at a plant; review the week together

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

Chamomile soothes a sore spot, but God made your skin to mend itself. What happens to a little scrape over the next few days?

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried chamomile flowers
- Hot water
- Mug
- Honey



Chamomile

Matricaria chamomilla

Read-Aloud & Discussion

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

STORY ORIENTATION

This week's story is "Life Force." Read it aloud together, and watch what happens to Gracie: she pricks her finger in the garden and discovers something astonishing. Her body begins to close the little cut all by itself, before anyone runs for help. Vovó shows her that God built that healing in from the very beginning, folded right into how we are made. Our herb this week is chamomile, a small, sweet flower that looks like a tiny daisy and has long been brewed into a gentle, calming tea. As your child listens, talk about a time their own body mended, a scrape that closed over, a bruise that slowly faded away. Help them picture the quiet work going on under the skin. This first unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at the garden and at the wonderful body He gave you. Wonder together: who taught your body to do that? God gave us every plant for good, and made us, from the very start, to heal.

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you skin to care for, and gave chamomile gentle flowers to soothe it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Gracie's cut began to heal before anyone helped – how did her body know what to do?
2. What has mended in you – a scrape, a bruise – without you even noticing?
3. I wonder, why would God make our bodies able to heal themselves?

MEMORY VERSE

I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them watch the tea steep, count the minutes on their fingers, then smell it. Just watch and smell.

OLDER SPROUTS

Have them retell, in their own words, how Gracie's cut healed itself – then draw the tiny 'wall' her blood built.

TODAY'S WORD:

CALM – a settled, peaceful state of body and mind, the opposite of being wound up tight.

How woven –

Bible: meeting the memory verse, Genesis 1:29, that God gave every plant for our good; Language Arts: your child hears "Life Force" and retells how Gracie's cut healed; Character: wonder – we learn to marvel at the body's quiet, designed work. Chamomile supports a calm body, a small picture of the peace God built into us from the start.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading)•R3 – retell the week's story (Story 1) in order

ELA (Speaking)•R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

DISCOVERY LESSON

Some flowers are so small they could hide behind a button, and chamomile is one. Set a dried chamomile flower in your child's palm and look close: white petals ring a round, golden middle that rises like a tiny dome. Some say it looks like a little sun, others a fried egg – let your child decide. Rub a flower gently and breathe in the sweet, apple-like smell, which is how chamomile earned a name meaning 'earth-apple.' Feel how light and papery the dried petals are. Ask your child to tell back what they saw and smelled. The same God who hung a sun in the sky tucked a tiny one into this gentle flower.

CORE QUESTION:

Look closely at a chamomile flower – what does its middle remind you of?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Look: white petals around a golden dome.
 2. Decide: a little sun, or a fried egg?
 3. Smell: the sweet, apple-like scent.
 4. Name it: chamomile is gentle and calming.
 5. Predict: will chamomile tea taste as sweet as it smells?
- Little Sprouts: point to the white petals and the gold middle.
Older Sprouts: tell how chamomile is like, and unlike, lavender.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a chamomile flower; label the white petals and gold middle.
Say it: *Matricaria chamomilla* – 'chamomile' means earth apple.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

NERVINE – an herb that calms and steadies the nerves.

How woven –

Science: observing a flower's petals and center;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

*Latin: its name, *Matricaria*.*

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe a chamomile flower's white petals and gold center
Science-R3 – identify chamomile's daisy shape, petals around a gold dome

Art-R3 – sketch and label a chamomile flower

Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Matricaria chamomilla*

Kitchen Lab

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

KITCHEN LAB

Today's Kitchen Lab is a cup of chamomile tea – another infusion, just like last week. We measure the little dried flowers, pour hot water, and let them steep until the water turns pale gold and smells of apples. Made and enjoyed the same day.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab: brew and taste today, then pour the rest out. A grown-up always handles the hot water and lets the tea cool before your child sips.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried chamomile flowers into a mug.
 2. Pour 8 oz of hot water over them.
 3. Cover and steep 5 minutes.
 4. Strain out the flowers.
 5. Add a little honey if you like; cool, then smell and taste.
- Little Sprouts: count the chamomile flowers into the mug and smell their soft apple scent.
- Older Sprouts: time the steep, strain the flowers, and tell how the water changed color.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: Chamomile is gentle, but it is a daisy cousin. If anyone sniffles around daisies or ragweed, check with a grown-up first.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child*

Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

INFUSION – a tea made by soaking flowers or leaves in hot water.

How woven –

Science: hot water pulls the flowers' gold color and apple scent into the cup;

Math: measure and time the 5-minute steep;

Health: a warm cup helps the body slow down.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – steep chamomile flowers into a pale-gold infusion

Math-R3 – measure 1 tsp and time a 5-minute steep

Health-R2 – a grown-up pours the hot water; check for daisy allergies

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "infusion"

History & Art

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

HISTORY LESSON

On the wide green banks of the Nile, in ancient Egypt, the sun blazed bright and hot. There, thousands of years ago, people loved the little chamomile flower. Its golden center and white petals reminded them of the sun, so they treasured it as a sun-herb. Egyptian healers are said to have brewed its gentle flowers to calm and comfort the body. Picture a blossom so small you could hide it behind your thumb, yet loved by a whole great kingdom! It reminds us that God often tucks His best gifts into the smallest, humblest packages – and gives us eyes to notice them.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

Every plant began at Creation, the third day God spoke (Genesis 1:11-12). Around 1500 BC, Egyptians along the Nile prized chamomile as a golden sun-herb to calm and comfort – a gentle flower loved since the world's oldest gardens.

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw a large golden circle for the Egyptian sun.
2. Around it, paint many small chamomile flowers like little suns.
3. Give each white petals around a gold center.
4. Add a Nile-blue border with simple Egyptian patterns.
5. Title it 'Egypt's Sun-Herb' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find Egypt and the Nile River in Africa. Long ago, people there grew chamomile in the warm Nile valley sunshine.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child*

Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

HEALER – someone who uses God's plants to help the body mend.

How woven –

History: chamomile in ancient Egypt;

Geography: Egypt and the Nile on the map;

Art: an Egyptian sun-disk of chamomile flowers;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

History-R2 – retell how ancient Egyptians prized chamomile as a sun-herb

Geography-R2 – locate Egypt and the Nile River

Art-R3 – paint an Egyptian sun-disk of chamomile flowers

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "healer"

Garden & Review

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

GARDEN ACTIVITY

LOOK WITH NEW EYES. A gardener's very first tool is not a shovel, it is a pair of careful eyes. When you slow down and really look, one plant becomes a hundred small wonders: tiny hairs, little veins, colors hiding inside colors. God packed the garden with beauty so you could look every day and still find something new. This unit we are learning to wonder, and wonder begins the moment you truly look.

DO: Pick one plant and study it closely. Count its colors. Is it round, spiky, or tall? Find one thing you never noticed before.

Little Sprouts: point to the greenest and the brightest thing you see.

Older Sprouts: draw the plant with every color and shape you can find.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: lemon balm – bright, lemony leaves that gladden the heart.

WEEK REVIEW

1. What does chamomile's gentle calm help your body do?
2. We brewed chamomile and looked closely at a plant. What surprised you?
3. God gave a tiny flower the power to calm us. What can you thank Him for?
4. You looked with a scientist's careful eyes. What tiny detail did you never notice before?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Genesis 1:29

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child*

"Even the smallest flower was made to bring us peace." – Vovó

Today's threads: Science • Language Arts • Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

OBSERVE – to look closely and carefully, the way a scientist does.

How woven –

Science: looking closely at a plant's colors and shapes;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Genesis 1:29 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

King's American Dispensary (Felter & Lloyd, 1898), 'Matricaria' · POWO, *Matricaria chamomilla* · NCCIH, *Chamomile* · NASB Genesis 1:29

FURTHER READING

Rosemary Gladstar's *Medicinal Herbs: A Beginner's Guide* – Rosemary Gladstar (parent read; take the sound herb-craft, discern and leave the 'plant spirit' spirituality of her wider work)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe a plant's colors and shapes closely

Math-R2 – count a plant's colors

ELA-R2 – answer the week's four review questions

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Lemon Balm, for bright spirits and calm



A joyful heart is good medicine.

Proverbs 17:22

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read Proverbs 17:22 – a joyful heart is good medicine; meet lemon balm's cheer.
- TUESDAY** Lemon balm discovery – feel the square stem, sketch
- WEDNESDAY** Make a lemon balm cordial – bruise, sweeten, sip
- THURSDAY** Ancient Greece – draw a bee-loved honey jar
- FRIDAY** Feel the garden's leaves; review the week

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

Lemon balm smells bright and glad, but that gladness is God's gift to you. What is a smell that makes you feel glad inside?

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Fresh lemon balm
- Jar
- Honey
- Lemon
- Ice
- Cool water (for the cordial)



Lemon Balm

Melissa officinalis

Read-Aloud & Discussion

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lemon Balm

Foundations - Mood & Calm

STORY ORIENTATION

Today we open to Proverbs 17. Read verse 22 aloud together and listen for the cheerful heart: "A joyful heart is good medicine." This unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at the garden and at the wonderful body He gave you, right down to the feelings tucked inside it. Our herb this week is lemon balm, a bright, lemony leaf that smells like sunshine in a cup, and that people have long brewed into a tea to lift the spirits and gladden a heavy heart. As your child listens, help them feel the difference between a gloomy, grey day and a glad, light one, the way a room feels when the sun comes out. Ask what kinds of things make their own heart feel light and happy. Lemon balm can cheer us a little, but real and lasting gladness is a gift from God, who loves to make our hearts merry. Read the verse once more together, and name one thing that makes you glad in Him today.

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you feelings that dip some days, and gave lemon balm a bright scent to cheer them.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What kinds of things make your heart feel glad and light?
2. Lemon balm can cheer us a little – where does real, lasting gladness come from?
3. I wonder – why does God care about a joyful heart, not only a healthy body?

MEMORY VERSE

A joyful heart is good medicine.

LEMON BALM CHANT

*Lemon balm is bright and green
Rub a leaf and smell the cheer
Gladdest leaf you've ever seen
Joy is near when clouds are here*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them crush one leaf and smell it, then say happy or sleepy. Carry a 'cheer-up' leaf to someone. Just crush and smell.

OLDER SPROUTS

Look up why the Greeks named lemon balm 'Melissa' (honeybee), then watch which blooms the bees actually visit outside.

TODAY'S WORD:

SPIRITS – our moods, the cheerful or heavy way we feel inside.

How woven –

Bible: hearing Proverbs 17:22, that a joyful heart is good medicine;

Language Arts: your child hears Proverbs 17:22 and retells it, gathering this week's new words;

Character: gladness – we practice a thankful, joyful heart. Lemon balm can lift the spirits for a moment, but lasting gladness is God's own gift.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading)-R2 – read and discuss Proverbs 17

ELA (Speaking)-R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lemon Balm

Foundations - Mood & Calm

DISCOVERY LESSON

This plant hides a secret in its stem, and we will sniff it out: lemon balm. Run your fingers down the stalk and feel for its edges – not round, but square, with four flat sides. That square stem is a clue: lemon balm belongs to the mint family, and nearly all mints share it. Now look at the leaves, wrinkled and heart-shaped, with a scalloped edge like tiny waves. Pinch one and smell – a bright lemon scent rises, though no lemon grows here. Ask your child to tell back the two clues that whisper 'mint': the square stem and the strong scent. God writes such clues all through His garden for careful eyes to find.

CORE QUESTION:

Roll a lemon balm stem: how many flat sides can your fingers feel?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Feel: run a finger down the square stem.
 2. Look: the wrinkled, heart-shaped leaves.
 3. Smell: pinch a leaf for its lemon scent.
 4. Name it: the square stem says 'mint family.'
 5. Compare: how is lemon balm different from last week's chamomile?
- Little Sprouts: rub a leaf and say what you smell.
Older Sprouts: explain why the square stem means 'mint family.'

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a lemon balm leaf; label its heart shape and square stem.
Say it: *Melissa officinalis* – Greek for 'honeybee'.

LEMON BALM CHANT

*Lemon balm is bright and green
Rub a leaf and smell the cheer
Gladdest leaf you've ever seen
Joy is near when clouds are here*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

UPLIFTING – an herb that gently brightens mood and spirits.

How woven –

Science: finding the mint family's square stem;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

Latin: its name, Melissa.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe lemon balm's heart-shaped leaves and lemon scent
Science-R4 – classify lemon balm as a mint by its square stem

Art-R3 – sketch and label a lemon balm leaf

Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Melissa officinalis*

Kitchen Lab

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lemon Balm

Foundations - Mood & Calm

KITCHEN LAB

Today's Kitchen Lab makes a lemon balm cordial – a sweet, lemony cooler. We bruise fresh lemon balm leaves, stir them with honey and a squeeze of lemon in cool water, and let the brightness come through. A cordial is just a sweet, gentle drink. Made and enjoyed today.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab: stir, sip, and enjoy today. No stove needed, but a grown-up cuts the lemon. Honey is never for babies under one year old.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Tear a small handful of fresh lemon balm leaves to bruise them.
2. Put them in a jar with 2 cups of cool water.
3. Stir in 1-2 spoons of honey and a squeeze of lemon.
4. Let it sit 10 minutes so the flavor wakes up.
5. Strain, pour over a little ice, and sip.

Can also be made into a tea: 1 tsp dried lemon balm + 8 oz hot water, steep 5 min.

Little Sprouts: tear the lemon balm leaves and rub one to smell the bright lemon.

Older Sprouts: measure the honey and water, stir, and taste before and after to compare.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: Lemon balm is friendly and safe! Just remember that honey is never for babies under one year old.

LEMON BALM CHANT

*Lemon balm is bright and green
Rub a leaf and smell the cheer
Gladdest leaf you've ever seen
Joy is near when clouds are here*

Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

CORDIAL – a sweet, gentle drink made with honey and herbs.

How woven –

Science: bruising the leaves frees their lemony oils into the cool water; Math: measure 2 cups of water and count the spoons of honey; Health: a cool, sweet drink can lift a gloomy mood.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – bruise lemon balm leaves to release flavor into a cool cordial

Math-R3 – measure 2 cups of water with honey and steep 10 minutes

Health-R2 – no honey for babies under one year old

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "cordial"

History & Art

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lemon Balm

Foundations - Mood & Calm

HISTORY LESSON

Honeybees hummed through the sunny gardens of ancient Greece. The Greeks noticed that bees adored one bright, lemony plant, returning to it again and again. So they named it Melissa – the Greek word for 'honeybee.' Greek beekeepers even rubbed lemon balm inside their hives to keep the bees happy and home. That old name never left: the plant's scientific name today is still *Melissa officinalis*. Isn't it lovely that a plant can be named for the little creature that loves it best? God made the bee and the balm to delight in each other, each one a gift to the other – and both a gift to us.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

On God's timeline plants come first, made on Day 3 (Genesis 1:11-12). More than 2,000 years ago the Greeks loved lemon balm so well – and its honeybees – that they named it Melissa, Greek for 'honeybee.'

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw a Greek honey jar in the middle of your page.
2. Around it, add heart-shaped, toothed lemon balm leaves.
3. Draw a few happy honeybees flying to the leaves.
4. Color the leaves bright green, the bees gold and black.
5. Title it 'Melissa, the Bee Herb' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find Greece on the map, across the Mediterranean Sea. Lemon balm grows wild on its sunny hillsides, loved by bees.

LEMON BALM CHANT

*Lemon balm is bright and green
Rub a leaf and smell the cheer
Gladdest leaf you've ever seen
Joy is near when clouds are here*

Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

MELISSA – Greek for 'honeybee,' lemon balm's old name.

How woven –

History: the bee-loving Greeks;

Geography: locating Greece and the Mediterranean;

Art: a Greek honey jar ringed with bees;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

History-R2 – retell how the Greeks named lemon balm for the honeybee
Geography-R2 – locate Greece across the Mediterranean Sea

Art-R3 – draw a Greek honey jar ringed with bees

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "melissa"

Garden & Review

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Lemon Balm

Foundations - Mood & Calm

GARDEN ACTIVITY

FEEL THE GARDEN. A good gardener learns to see with gentle hands as well as with eyes. God gave plants all kinds of skins: some smooth, some fuzzy, some waxy, some prickly. Each skin has a job, holding in water or keeping the plant safe, and your fingers can tell them apart even with your eyes closed. This unit we are waking up all our senses to wonder at the garden God made.

DO: With clean fingers, gently touch several different leaves. Sort them: smooth, fuzzy, or waxy? Which one is your favorite to touch?

Little Sprouts: find one soft leaf and one rough leaf.

Older Sprouts: guess a leaf just by touch, eyes closed, then look to check.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: peppermint – a cool, tingly mint that the tummy loves.

WEEK REVIEW

1. How does lemon balm's lemony cheer lift your spirits?
2. The Greeks named it 'Melissa' for the bees. Why do bees and people love it?
3. A joyful heart is good medicine. What fills your heart with gladness?
4. You felt smooth, fuzzy, and prickly leaves. Which was your favorite to touch, and why?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Proverbs 17:22

LEMON BALM CHANT

*Lemon balm is bright and green
Rub a leaf and smell the cheer
Gladdest leaf you've ever seen
Joy is near when clouds are here*

"A glad heart is good medicine – and God grows it in the garden." –

Vovó

Today's threads: Science • Language Arts • Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

TEXTURE – the way something feels, like smooth, fuzzy, or prickly.

How woven –

Science: sorting leaves by how they feel;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Proverbs 17:22 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

Grieve, A Modern Herbal (1931), 'Balm' • POWO, *Melissa officinalis* • NASB Proverbs 17:22

FURTHER READING

Botany in a Day – Thomas J. Elpel (parent read)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – feel and describe different leaf textures

Math-R2 – sort leaves into feel groups

ELA-R2 – answer the week's four review questions

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Peppermint, for a happy tummy and cooling



It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones.

Proverbs 3:8

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read "Vovó's Lineage" – herb-wisdom handed down; meet cooling peppermint.
- TUESDAY** Peppermint discovery – crush, smell the cool, sketch
- WEDNESDAY** Make a peppermint compress – brew, cool, cloth
- THURSDAY** Mitcham, England – draw peppermint fields
- FRIDAY** Smell the garden's plants; review the week

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

*Peppermint cools a busy tummy, but God
gave you that tummy to do good work.
What good work does your tummy do for
you?*

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried peppermint
- Bowl
- Hot water
- Clean cloth



Peppermint

Mentha × piperita

Read-Aloud & Discussion

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Peppermint

Foundations • Tummy & Cooling

STORY ORIENTATION

This week's story is "Vovó's Lineage." Read it aloud together. Gracie finds an old photograph of Vovó's grandmother, Nona, standing in a faraway garden and holding a small sprig of peppermint. Vovó tells how Nona, who came all the way across the ocean from Europe to Brazil, taught her everything in the kitchen, that the meal, the medicine, and the love were all one thing woven together. Our herb this week is peppermint, cool and bright, long used to settle a busy tummy and wake up a tired head. Rub a leaf and let your child smell that fresh, tingly scent for themselves. As they listen, talk about something an older person in your own family has taught you with their hands. This unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at the garden and the wonderful body He gave you. Wonder together: how does God pass His good gifts down, from hands to hands, across the long years?

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you a tummy, and made peppermint cool and bright to settle it when it's busy.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Nona taught Vovó in the kitchen – who has taught you something good?
2. Vovó made peppermint tea to help her family feel better. How do people in your home show they care when someone feels sick?
3. I wonder, why might God pass His gifts from grandparents to grandchildren?

MEMORY VERSE

It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones.

PEPPERMINT CHANT

*Peppermint is cool and bright
Settles tummies, calm and clean
Minty fresh and frosty light
Freshest leaf you've ever seen*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them pinch a leaf, breathe the cool, and taste a tiny piece, then say what the mouth and nose feel. Just breathe and taste.

OLDER SPROUTS

Ask why a hybrid mint can't grow true from seed, and have them explain why we root a cutting instead.

TODAY'S WORD:

TUMMY – the belly, where the body breaks down food and sometimes feels hot or tight; peppermint has long helped it feel cool and settled.

How woven –

Bible: the memory verse, Proverbs 3:8, health to the body;

Language Arts: your child hears "Vovó's Lineage" and retells how Nona taught Vovó; Character: honor – we treasure what older hands pass down. Peppermint, handed from Nona to Vovó to Gracie, supports a calm tummy – a good gift carried gently across the years.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading)•R3 – retell the week's story (Story 2) in order

ELA (Speaking)•R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Peppermint

Foundations - Tummy & Cooling

DISCOVERY LESSON

Let your nose lead the way today, because peppermint is all about scent. Pinch a leaf, crush it a little, and breathe in deep. Notice the surprise: the air feels cool inside your nose, almost like a small breeze. That cool feeling comes from menthol, which peppermint makes – it gently tricks the cool-sensing spots in our skin and nose. Look at the leaves, deep green with tiny teeth along the edge, and check the stem for a hint of purple. Ask your child to describe the cool feeling in their own words. The God who made the mint also made the clever skin that feels its coolness.

CORE QUESTION:

After you smell peppermint, why might your nose feel cool inside?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Pinch: crush a peppermint leaf.
 2. Smell: breathe deep – feel the cool inside.
 3. Look: toothed leaves, purple-tinged stem.
 4. Name it: the cool comes from menthol.
 5. Wonder: what does peppermint's cool make you wonder about God?
- Little Sprouts: pinch a leaf and feel the cool.
Older Sprouts: explain where peppermint's cool comes from (menthol).

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a peppermint leaf; label its teeth and stem.
Say it: *Mentha × piperita* – the x means a hybrid mint.

PEPPERMINT CHANT

*Peppermint is cool and bright
Settles tummies, calm and clean
Minty fresh and frosty light
Freshest leaf you've ever seen*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

CARMINATIVE – an herb that soothes a gassy, bubbly tummy.
How woven –
Science: feeling menthol's cooling trick;
Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;
Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;
Latin: its name, *Mentha*.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe peppermint's toothed leaves and cool menthol scent
Science-R3 – identify menthol, the oil behind peppermint's cool
Art-R3 – sketch and label a peppermint leaf
Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Mentha × piperita*

Kitchen Lab

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Peppermint

Foundations - Tummy & Cooling

KITCHEN LAB

Today's Kitchen Lab makes a peppermint compress – a cool cloth for tired skin, not a drink. We brew a strong peppermint tea, dip and wring a cloth, and let the menthol cool the skin. Made and used today, then poured out.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab; a compress is for the skin, not for drinking. A grown-up handles the hot water and cools it before it touches skin.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 Tbsp of dried peppermint into a bowl.
 2. Pour over 8 oz of hot water; steep 10 minutes.
 3. Strain, then let the tea cool until just warm.
 4. Dip a clean cloth and wring it out.
 5. Lay the cool cloth on the forehead or arm, then rinse it after.
- Can also be made into a tea: 1 tsp dried peppermint + 8 oz hot water, steep 5 min.
- Little Sprouts: smell the peppermint and feel the cloth turn cool.
- Older Sprouts: wring out the cool cloth and time how long it rests on the skin.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: Peppermint is cool and strong! Keep a compress off the eyes and face. Peppermint essential oil is very strong.

PEPPERMINT CHANT

*Peppermint is cool and bright
Settles tummies, calm and clean
Minty fresh and frosty light
Freshest leaf you've ever seen*

Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

COMPRESS – a cloth soaked in herb tea, laid on the skin to cool or soothe.

How woven –

Science: the cooling menthol passes from the tea into the cloth and onto the skin;

Math: measure and time the steep;

Health: a cool compress comforts warm or tired skin.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – brew a strong tea and soak a cloth for a cooling compress

Math-R3 – measure 1 Tbsp and time a 10-minute steep

Health-R2 – a compress is for skin, not drinking; keep it off the eyes

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "compress"

History & Art

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made · Pillar 1

Peppermint

Foundations - Tummy & Cooling

HISTORY LESSON

Not so very long ago, in England, stood a little town called Mitcham. Mitcham grew so famous for its peppermint that the fields rolled out in waves of green, and the cool, sweet smell drifted for miles on the breeze. People traveled far to buy 'Mitcham mint,' known as the finest in all the world. Whole families worked side by side at harvest, cutting the fragrant plants by hand. Imagine a town remembered not for gold or castles, but for one humble, cooling herb! It shows us how God can use ordinary, hardworking hands and a simple plant to bring blessing to people near and far.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

Plants began on Creation's third day (Genesis 1:11-12). Much later, about 250 years ago, the town of Mitcham in England grew the world's most famous peppermint, its green fields known far and wide for the finest 'Mitcham mint.'

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw a wide English field stretching to the horizon.
2. Fill it with long rows of green peppermint plants.
3. Add a little village and a cart for the harvest.
4. Color it all cool green under a soft blue sky.
5. Title it 'The Mint Fields of Mitcham' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find England, and the town of Mitcham near London. Its cool, damp fields once grew the world's most famous peppermint.

PEPPERMINT CHANT

*Peppermint is cool and bright
Settles tummies, calm and clean
Minty fresh and frosty light
Freshest leaf you've ever seen*

Today's threads: History · Geography · Art · Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

MITCHAM – the English town famous for the world's finest peppermint.

How woven –

History: the great Mitcham mint fields;

Geography: finding England near London;

Art: a harvest field landscape;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

History-R2 – describe the famous mint fields of Mitcham, England

Geography-R2 – locate England and Mitcham near London

Art-R3 – draw the harvest mint fields of Mitcham

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "mitcham"

Garden & Review

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made · Pillar 1

Peppermint

Foundations · Tummy & Cooling

GARDEN ACTIVITY

SMELL THE GARDEN. Lean in close and you will find God tucked a secret scent inside so many plants. Some are strong, some are soft, some are sweet as candy. That smell is not there by accident; it can call the bees, keep bugs away, or simply fill the air with wonder. A gardener's nose helps tell one plant from another. This unit we are using every sense to marvel at the garden God made.

DO: Gently rub a leaf and smell your fingers. Try three different plants. Which is strongest? Which would you want beside your pillow at night? Little Sprouts: smell one herb and say if you like it.

Older Sprouts: smell three, then guess each one by its scent with your eyes closed.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: calendula – a golden flower that supports our skin.

WEEK REVIEW

1. When your tummy feels uneasy, how can cool peppermint help?
2. You felt peppermint's cool, then a cool compress. Where did the cool come from?
3. Peppermint is a hybrid of two mints. What does that make you wonder about God?
4. You smelled many garden plants. Which scent would you want to keep close by?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Proverbs 3:8

PEPPERMINT CHANT

*Peppermint is cool and bright
Settles tummies, calm and clean
Minty fresh and frosty light
Freshest leaf you've ever seen*

"God made the cool and the warm, and both are a kindness." – Vovó

Today's threads: Science · Language Arts · Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

SCENT – the smell a plant gives off.

How woven –

Science: comparing the scents of different plants;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Proverbs 3:8 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

King's American Dispensary (1898), 'Mentha Piperita' · Grieve (1931), 'Mints' · POWO, *Mentha × piperita* · NCCIH, Peppermint Oil · NASB Proverbs 3:8 (cool compress = modern child-safe adaptation)

FURTHER READING

A Modern Herbal – Maud Grieve (parent read; a 1931 classic; it records old herb-folklore, including magical and astrological lore, as history to note, not to practice)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – compare plants by their scent

Math-R2 – order three scents from soft to strong

ELA-R2 – answer the week's four review questions

He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

Psalm 147:3

MONDAY	<i>Read Psalm 147:3 – God binds up wounds; meet calendula's golden, skin-soothing petals.</i>
TUESDAY	<i>Calendula discovery – count gold petals, sketch</i>
WEDNESDAY	<i>Make a calendula dressing – steep, soak, lay on</i>
THURSDAY	<i>Medieval gardens – paint marigold gold</i>
FRIDAY	<i>Be still and watch for visitors; review the week</i>

- Dried calendula petals
- Bowl
- Hot water
- Cloth or gauze



Calendula

Calendula officinalis

Read-Aloud & Discussion

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Calendula

Foundations - Skin & Renewal

STORY ORIENTATION

Today we open the Bible to Psalm 147. Read verses 1 to 3 aloud, slowly, and listen for the line about wounds: "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." This unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at the garden and at the wonderful body He gave you, a body that God so kindly loves to mend. Our herb this week is calendula, a cheerful golden flower, bright as a little sun, that families have long laid over a scraped knee to comfort the skin. As your child listens, help them notice two kinds of hurt: the kind on the outside, like a scrape a bandage can cover, and the quieter kind on the inside, in the heart, that only God can reach. The same God who gave calendula its gentle gift also binds up the wounds we cannot see. Read the verse once more, and let your child hear that they are cared for, all the way through, inside and out.

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you skin that gets bumped, and gave calendula golden petals to soothe it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. God binds up our wounds – who heals the hurts we cannot see?
2. A bandage helps the outside; what hurt can only God reach?
3. I wonder – why did God give calendula such gentle care for our skin?

MEMORY VERSE

He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

CALENDULA CHANT

*Calendula, gold and bright
Soothes a scrape and calms the skin
Petals warm as morning light
Mary's gold, soft care within*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them count the gold petals out loud and press one flat inside a heavy book. Just count and press.

OLDER SPROUTS

Have them count a calendula's petals and explain how a flower that opens with the sun earns the name 'calendar'.

TODAY'S WORD:

EPIDERMIS – the outer layer of our skin, the part we can see and touch.

How woven –

Bible: hearing Psalm 147:3, that God heals the brokenhearted and binds up wounds;

Language Arts: your child hears Psalm 147 and retells it, gathering this week's new words;

Character: compassion – we see God bind up the brokenhearted and learn to comfort others. Calendula tends the epidermis, a small picture of the God who cares for every hurt.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading)•R2 – read and discuss Psalm 147

ELA (Speaking)•R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Calendula

Foundations - Skin & Renewal

DISCOVERY LESSON

It glows on the table like a little coin of gold: calendula. Set one in your child's palm and look: many slim petals circle out from the center, layer upon layer, in bright orange and yellow. Touch the back of the flower and the stem and feel a faint stickiness; that is calendula's resin, part of why people have long loved it for the skin. Watch the flower over a day if you can: calendula opens to the sun and folds shut when clouds roll in. Ask your child why God might dress a humble garden flower in such bright gold. Careful eyes find glory even in a flowerbed.

CORE QUESTION:

Why might God have given calendula such a bright, sunny gold?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Look: slim gold petals, layer on layer.
 2. Touch: feel the sticky resin on the stem.
 3. Watch: it opens to sun, shuts in clouds.
 4. Name it: a bright flower long loved for skin.
 5. Say today's word, VULNERARY – herbs that comfort the skin.
- Little Sprouts: point to the many gold petals.
Older Sprouts: tell how calendula helps a small scrape.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a calendula bloom; label its many gold petals.

Say it: *Calendula officinalis* – from 'calendar' – blooms for months.

CALENDULA CHANT

*Calendula, gold and bright
Soothes a scrape and calms the skin
Petals warm as morning light
Mary's gold, soft care within*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

VULNERARY – an herb that comforts and supports the skin.

How woven –

Science: watching a flower open and close;
Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;
Latin: its name, *Calendula*.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe calendula's gold petals and sticky stem

Science-R3 – watch calendula open to the sun and close in cloud

Art-R3 – sketch and label a calendula bloom

Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Calendula officinalis*

Kitchen Lab

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Calendula

Foundations - Skin & Renewal

KITCHEN LAB

Today's Kitchen Lab makes a calendula dressing – a soft, soothing cloth for the skin. We steep the golden petals into a strong tea, then soak a clean cloth to lay gently over a small scrape. A dressing covers and comforts the skin. Made and used today.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab; a dressing is for the skin, not for drinking. A grown-up handles the hot water and cools it before it touches skin.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 Tbsp of dried calendula petals into a bowl.
 2. Pour over 8 oz of hot water; steep 10 minutes.
 3. Strain, then cool until just warm.
 4. Soak a clean cloth or gauze and wring it.
 5. Lay it gently on clean skin for a few minutes.
- Can also be made into a tea: 1 tsp dried calendula + 8 oz hot water, steep 5 min.
- Little Sprouts: count the golden calendula petals into the bowl.
- Older Sprouts: soak and wring the cloth, and tell why we use it only on clean, small scrapes.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: Calendula is a gentle daisy cousin! Use it only on clean, small scrapes – never a deep cut. Check first if daisies or ragweed bother you.

CALENDULA CHANT

*Calendula, gold and bright
Soothes a scrape and calms the skin
Petals warm as morning light
Mary's gold, soft care within*

Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

DRESSING – a soft, herb-soaked cloth laid over the skin to comfort it.

How woven –

Science: a strong steep pulls the petals' soothing goodness into the cloth;

Math: measure petals and time the steep;

Health: a gentle dressing comforts a small scrape.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – steep calendula into a strong tea and soak a soothing dressing

Math-R3 – measure 1 Tbsp and time a 10-minute steep

Health-R2 – use on clean, small scrapes only, never a deep cut
ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "dressing"

History & Art

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Calendula

Foundations - Skin & Renewal

HISTORY LESSON

Long ago in the Middle Ages, stone castles and quiet monasteries dotted the land. In those days, monks and nuns grew calendula in their garden beds, prizing its golden flowers for soothing the skin. People of that time gave the bright bloom a tender nickname – they called it 'Mary's gold,' which slowly softened over the years into the word we still use: marigold. Picture rows of glowing orange-gold flowers warming a grey stone garden. It reminds us that in every age, for hundreds of years, people have found in God's plants a gift of care and beauty, handed down at last to us.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

Every plant traces back to Creation, Day 3 (Genesis 1:11-12). About 1,000 years ago, in medieval monastery gardens, monks and nuns grew calendula for the skin and called it 'Mary's gold' – the name that became marigold.

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw one calendula bloom large in the center.
2. Fill it with many thin gold and orange petals.
3. Frame it with a fancy medieval-manuscript border.
4. Add gold dots and curls in the corners.
5. Title it 'Mary's Gold' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find southern Europe on the map. Calendula came from these warm Mediterranean lands and bloomed in medieval gardens.

CALENDULA CHANT

*Calendula, gold and bright
Soothes a scrape and calms the skin
Petals warm as morning light
Mary's gold, soft care within*

Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

MARIGOLD – 'Mary's gold,' the old name that softened into 'marigold.'

How woven –

History: calendula in medieval monastery gardens;

Geography: southern Europe on the map;

Art: an illuminated-manuscript bloom;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

History-R2 – retell how medieval monks grew calendula as Mary's gold

Geography-R2 – locate southern Europe

Art-R3 – draw an illuminated-manuscript calendula bloom

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "marigold"

Garden & Review

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Calendula

Foundations - Skin & Renewal

GARDEN ACTIVITY

BE STILL AND WATCH. A garden shows its secrets only to a quiet watcher. Stand still and you will see it is full of busy visitors God made, coming and going all day long. A bee stops for a drink, an ant marches on an errand, a bird darts past on wings. They were there the whole time; you only had to grow still enough to notice. This unit we are slowing down to wonder at all that God-made life.

DO: Stand very still by a plant or window for two whole minutes. Watch for a visitor, a bee, a fly, a bird, an ant. Who came?

Little Sprouts: watch for one visitor and wave it hello.

Older Sprouts: count the visitors in two minutes and draw one.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: plantain – a humble path-side leaf with a quiet gift.

WEEK REVIEW

1. How does calendula support your skin after a small scrape?
2. We steeped calendula's petals into a soothing dressing. How can one little flower give such gentle care?
3. God binds up wounds and gave us calendula for our skin. What does that show about His care?
4. You stood still and watched. Which garden visitor was your favorite to see?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Psalm 147:3

CALENDULA CHANT

*Calendula, gold and bright
Soothes a scrape and calms the skin
Petals warm as morning light
Mary's gold, soft care within*

"The same hands that mend our skin are mending our hearts." – Vovó

Today's threads: Science • Language Arts • Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

VISITOR – a creature that comes to the garden, like a bee or a bird.

How woven –

Science: watching quietly for garden visitors;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Psalm 147:3 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

King's American Dispensatory (1898),
'Calendula' • POWO,
Calendula officinalis •
NASB Psalm 147:3

FURTHER READING

Backyard Medicine – Julie Bruton-Seal & Matthew Seal (parent read)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – watch quietly for the garden's visitors

Math-R2 – count the garden's visitors

ELA-R2 – answer the week's four review questions



Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

Matthew 5:5

MONDAY *Read Matthew 5:5 – blessed are the gentle; meet humble plantain, a comfort for skin.*

TUESDAY *Plantain discovery – hunt it, feel the veins, sketch*

WEDNESDAY *Make a plantain poultice – mash, apply, wipe*

THURSDAY *Old Europe & Asia – draw a path of plantain*

FRIDAY *Meet the garden's creatures; review the week*

- Fresh plantain leaf
- Bowl to mash
- Clean cloth



Plantain
Plantago major

Read-Aloud & Discussion

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Plantain

Foundations - Skin & Gentle Care

STORY ORIENTATION

Today we read from Matthew 5, the words of Jesus on the mountain. Read verses 3 to 5 aloud and listen for the gentle ones: "Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth." This unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at the garden and at the wonderful body He gave you, and at how God loves the small and the lowly things best of all. Our herb this week is plantain, a humble little weed with broad green leaves that most people walk right past without a second look. Yet God tucked a real gift inside those plain leaves, long used to comfort the skin after a bug bite or a scrape. Ask your child why they think God would hide something so helpful in a plant so small and plain. The God who notices a weed by the sidewalk notices your child too, and loves the gentle and the small. Read the verse once more together, and thank Him for seeing you.

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you skin that meets the world, and gave plantain broad leaves to comfort it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Jesus blesses the gentle – what does it mean to be gentle?
2. Why would God hide a real gift inside a small, humble weed?
3. I wonder – what gifts has God tucked into the plants we walk past?

MEMORY VERSE

Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

PLANTAIN CHANT

*Plantain grows along the way
Humble weed beneath our feet
Draws the sting and saves the day
God hides helpers small and sweet*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them spot plantain along the path and count them, then trace a leaf's lines with one finger. Just count and trace.

OLDER SPROUTS

Ask why a plant nobody planted grows right where people walk – and what the old name 'waybread' reveals about it.

TODAY'S WORD:

BARRIER – the body's outer guard wall, our skin, that keeps trouble out.

How woven –

Bible: hearing Matthew 5:5, that the gentle are blessed; Language Arts: your child hears Matthew 5 and retells it, gathering this week's new words;

Character: gentleness – Jesus blesses the gentle and the humble. Plantain, a lowly weed, is a friend to the barrier God wrapped around you.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading)•R2 – read and discuss Matthew 5

ELA (Speaking)•R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Plantain

Foundations - Skin & Gentle Care

DISCOVERY LESSON

Let's go hunting for plantain, and we may not have to look far. This humble plant grows right where people walk: lawns, path edges, the cracks in a sidewalk. Pick a leaf and look: see the strong lines, called veins, running side by side from base to tip. Now pull the leaf apart slowly and watch those veins hold on like tiny strings – that is plantain's quiet strength. Feel the low rosette of leaves hugging the ground. Ask your child why a plant might grow tough and low right where feet tread. God tucked a real gift into a weed most people pass by, and gave your child eyes to notice it.

CORE QUESTION:

Run a finger along a plantain leaf – what ridged lines do you feel?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Find: plantain in a path or sidewalk crack.
 2. Look: strong veins running side by side.
 3. Pull: a leaf apart – see the string-like veins.
 4. Name it: a tough little plant underfoot.
 5. Predict: what will plantain's tough leaf feel like, smooth or stringy?
- Little Sprouts: find plantain's strong lines (veins) on a leaf.
Older Sprouts: explain how those veins make the leaf hard to tear.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a plantain leaf; label its parallel veins.
Say it: *Plantago major* – planta, 'sole of the foot'.

PLANTAIN CHANT

*Plantain grows along the way
Humble weed beneath our feet
Draws the sting and saves the day
God hides helpers small and sweet*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

DRAWING – an herb that helps draw out a sting or splinter.

How woven –

Science: tracing a leaf's parallel veins;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

Latin: its name, *Plantago*.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe plantain's strong parallel leaf veins

Science-R3 – explain how plantain's parallel veins keep the leaf from tearing

Art-R3 – sketch and label a plantain leaf

Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Plantago major*

Kitchen Lab

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Plantain

Foundations - Skin & Gentle Care

KITCHEN LAB

Today's Kitchen Lab makes a plantain poultice – the oldest first-aid trick there is. We mash a clean plantain leaf until the juices come out, then lay the green mash on a bug bite to comfort the skin. Quick, simple, and used the same day.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab; a poultice goes on the skin, not in the mouth. Use only clean, unsprayed leaves that a grown-up has checked.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Pick and rinse a fresh, clean plantain leaf.
2. Mash it (a grown-up helps) until juicy.
3. Lay the green mash on a bug bite or sting.
4. Hold it on with a cloth for a few minutes.
5. Wipe clean when done – never save it.

Can also be made into a tea: 1 tsp dried plantain + 8 oz hot water, steep 5 min.

Little Sprouts: help pick and rinse one clean plantain leaf.

Older Sprouts: mash the leaf into a green poultice and tell how it soothes a bug bite.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: Use only clean, unsprayed plantain! A poultice goes on tiny bites, never a deep cut. Ask a grown-up to pick it.

PLANTAIN CHANT

*Plantain grows along the way
Humble weed beneath our feet
Draws the sting and saves the day
God hides helpers small and sweet*

Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

POULTICE – soft, mashed plant laid right on the skin to soothe.

How woven –

Science: mashing the leaf breaks it open to release its soothing juices;

Math: count the minutes you hold it on;

Health: a cool poultice comforts an itchy bug bite.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – mash a plantain leaf into a poultice that comforts the skin

Math-R3 – count the minutes you hold the poultice on

Health-R2 – use clean, unsprayed leaves; a poultice goes on skin, not in the mouth
ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "poultice"

History & Art

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made · Pillar 1

Plantain

Foundations - Skin & Gentle Care

HISTORY LESSON

Picture England many hundreds of years ago, in the days of the Anglo-Saxons. They treasured the humble plantain so dearly that they named it 'waybread' – because it sprang up along the 'ways,' the paths and roadsides where people walked. They even counted it among nine of their most valued healing plants. Imagine a weed so common you might step right over it, yet honored and remembered for hundreds of years! Plantain is so steady and tough that it follows people wherever they go – a quiet reminder that some of God's most faithful helpers are the ones we pass by every day without a second look.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

God made the plants on Creation's third day (Genesis 1:11-12). Over 1,000 years ago the Anglo-Saxons of England counted humble plantain among nine treasured healing herbs and called it 'waybread,' for it grew along every path.

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw a winding path across your page.
2. Along its edges, add low plantain with broad leaves.
3. Show the strong veins running up each leaf.
4. Color the leaves green, the path brown and gray.
5. Title it 'Waybread by the Path' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find Europe and Asia on the map – plantain's first home. Today it follows people's paths on almost every continent!

PLANTAIN CHANT

*Plantain grows along the way
Humble weed beneath our feet
Draws the sting and saves the day
God hides helpers small and sweet*

Today's threads: History · Geography · Art · Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

WAYBREAD – the Anglo-Saxon name for plantain, the plant of the paths.

How woven –

History: plantain among nine treasured herbs;

Geography: Europe and Asia on the map;

Art: a path lined with plantain;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

History-R2 – retell how the Anglo-Saxons prized plantain as waybread
Geography-R2 – locate Europe and Asia

Art-R3 – draw a path lined with plantain

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "waybread"

Garden & Review

Unit 1: In the Garden God Made • Pillar 1

Plantain

Foundations • Skin & Gentle Care

GARDEN ACTIVITY

GARDEN FRIENDS. A garden is never empty. It is a busy home full of worms, bugs, and birds that God made to share it. Each little friend has a job: a worm softens the soil, a bee carries pollen, a beetle tidies up. They help the garden grow in ways too small for us to see, so a kind gardener treats every one of them gently. This unit we are learning to wonder at all the life God tucked into the garden He made.

DO: Find one small creature, a worm, a beetle, a ladybug. Watch it, give it room, then let it be. Never squish a garden friend.

Little Sprouts: find a bug and watch how it moves.

Older Sprouts: draw it and give it a gentle name.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: fennel – sweet, feathery seeds, and a brand-new unit: When Your Body Talks!

WEEK REVIEW

1. How does a humble plantain leaf support your skin?
2. You found plantain by the path, then made a poultice. Why grow a helper where people walk?
3. Jesus blessed the lowly. What makes you wonder that God hid help in a weed?
4. You met a garden creature up close. How can you be gentle with the small ones God made?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Matthew 5:5

PLANTAIN CHANT

*Plantain grows along the way
Humble weed beneath our feet
Draws the sting and saves the day
God hides helpers small and sweet*

"God hides His best gifts in humble places – look down, meu amor." –

Vovó

Today's threads: Science • Math • Movement • Language Arts • Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

CREATURE – a living animal, like a worm, a bug, or a bird.

How woven –

Science: observing a small garden creature up close;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Matthew 5:5 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

Grieve (1931), 'Plantain' • King's American Dispensatory (1898), 'Plantago' • POWO, *Plantago major* • NASB Matthew 5:5

FURTHER READING

The Forager's Harvest – Samuel Thayer (parent read)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe a garden creature and treat it gently

Math-R2 – count the creatures you find

ELA-R2 – answer the week's four review questions

SPROUTS (GRADES K-2) - STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

*Eden's Table - Biblical Herbalism Homeschool Curriculum - Teacher's Guide
Week-by-Week / Day-by-Day Coverage of National K-2 Standards*

FRAMEWORKS ALIGNED (all applicable countrywide standards for K-2):

- CCSS-ELA Common Core State Standards, English Language Arts (K, 1, 2)
- CCSS-MATH ... Common Core State Standards, Mathematics (K, 1, 2)
- NGSS Next Generation Science Standards (K, 1, 2, K-2)
- C3 / NCSS ... College, Career & Civic Life (C3) Framework for Social Studies
- NGS National Geography Standards
- NCAS National Core Arts Standards, Visual Arts (K, 1, 2)
- NHES National Health Education Standards (PreK-Grade 2)
- ACTFL ACTFL World-Readiness Standards for Learning Languages (Latin)
- CASEL CASEL Framework for Social & Emotional Learning (Character)
- Biblical worldview is woven daily (memory verses, Creation, stewardship);
this is the curriculum's faith foundation and sits outside secular frameworks.

*Grades K-2 are taught together ("Little Sprouts" / "Older Sprouts" tiers), so each standard is addressed at the Kindergarten, Grade 1, and Grade 2 level.
Notation "RL.K-2.1" = the K.1, 1.1, and 2.1 versions of that standard.*

MASTER LIST - EVERY STANDARD ADDRESSED ACROSS THE YEAR

CCSS-ELA -- READING: LITERATURE (Monday read-aloud story; daily chant/poem)

- RL.K-2.1 Ask & answer questions about key details in a story*
- RL.K-2.2 Retell/recount stories & determine central message or lesson*
- RL.K-2.3 Identify/describe characters, settings & major events*
- RL.K-2.4 Identify words & rhythm that suggest feelings (the weekly herb chant)*
- RL.K-2.7 Use illustrations & words to understand a story*
- RL.K-2.10 Engage with stories & poetry within the K-2 range*

CCSS-ELA -- READING: INFORMATIONAL (Thursday history; Wed lab procedure; facts)

- RI.K-2.1 Ask & answer questions about key details in an informational text*
- RI.K-2.2 Identify the main topic & retell key details*
- RI.K-2.3 Describe the connection between events, ideas, or steps in a process*
- RI.K-2.4 Determine the meaning of words in a text*
- RI.K-2.7 Use images/illustrations to understand informational text*

CCSS-ELA -- READING: FOUNDATIONAL SKILLS (recitation, chant, print)

RF.K-1.1 Demonstrate understanding of print concepts

RF.K-1.2 Demonstrate phonological awareness (rhyme & rhythm in the chant)

RF.K-2.3 Apply grade-level phonics & word-analysis skills

RF.K-2.4 Read/recite with sufficient accuracy & fluency (verse & chant recitation)

CCSS-ELA -- WRITING

W.K-2.2 Write informative/explanatory texts (label a diagram, name/describe)

W.K-2.8 Recall information to answer a question (Nature Notebook, review)

CCSS-ELA -- SPEAKING & LISTENING (discussion, describe, recite, present)

SL.K-2.1 Participate in collaborative conversations (discussion questions)

SL.K-2.2 Confirm understanding of / recount a text read aloud

SL.K-2.3 Ask & answer questions to gather information or clarify

SL.K-2.4 Describe people, places, things & events with relevant detail

SL.K-2.5 Add drawings/visual displays to descriptions (Nature Notebook sketch)

SL.K-2.6 Speak audibly in complete sentences (recite verse & chant)

CCSS-ELA -- LANGUAGE (vocabulary "Today's Word"; Latin roots; word relationships)

L.K-2.1 Command of grammar & complete sentences when speaking

L.K-2.4 Determine/clarify meaning of unknown words (incl. Latin root words)

L.K-2.5 Word relationships & nuances; sort/categorize; real-life connections

L.K-2.6 Use newly acquired conversational & content vocabulary

CCSS-MATH (Wednesday Kitchen Lab measuring/timing; Friday counting/sorting)

K.CC.A.1 Count to 100 by ones and tens

K.CC.B.4/5 Count objects to tell "how many"

K.MD.A.1/2 Describe & compare measurable attributes of objects

K.MD.B.3 Classify objects into categories & count them (sort living/nonliving)

1.MD.A.1/2 Order & measure lengths using units

1.MD.B.3 Tell and write time (time the herb steep)

1.MD.C.4 Organize, represent & interpret data

2.MD.A.1 Measure length using appropriate tools

2.MD.C.7 Tell and write time

2.MD.D.10 Draw a picture graph/bar graph to represent data

*(Volume/quantity measures -- tsp, cups, oz -- are taught under the MD domain;
drawing plant/leaf shapes touches K-2.G geometry.)*

NGSS -- LIFE SCIENCE (Tuesday Discovery; Friday Garden)

K-LS1-1 Use observations to describe what plants & animals need to survive

1-LS1-1 Plants & animals use external parts to survive, grow & meet needs

1-LS3-1 Young plants & animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents

2-LS2-1 Investigate whether plants need sunlight & water to grow

2-LS4-1 Make observations to compare the diversity of life in habitats

NGSS -- PHYSICAL SCIENCE (Wednesday Kitchen Lab)

2-PS1-1 Describe & classify materials by their observable properties

2-PS1-4 Some changes caused by heating/cooling can be reversed (infusion/steeping)

NGSS -- EARTH & ENGINEERING (garden environment; sketch/model; procedure)

K-ESS3-1 Relationship between the needs of plants/animals & their environment

K-2-ETS1-1 Ask questions & make observations to define a problem

K-2-ETS1-2 Develop a simple sketch/model to illustrate an idea (Nature Notebook)

NGSS -- SCIENCE & ENGINEERING PRACTICES (woven through every science day)

SEP-1 Asking questions SEP-3 Planning & carrying out investigations

SEP-4 Analyzing & interpreting data SEP-6 Constructing explanations

SEP-8 Obtaining, evaluating & communicating information (labeled drawings, tell-back)

NGSS -- CROSSCUTTING CONCEPTS

*Patterns * Cause & Effect * Structure & Function (plant parts) * Systems (garden)*

C3 / NCSS SOCIAL STUDIES + NATIONAL GEOGRAPHY STANDARDS (Thursday History & Map)

D2.His.1.K-2 Create a chronological sequence of events (Creation-care timeline)

D2.His.2.K-2 Compare life in the past to life today

D2.His.3.K-2 Generate questions about the past

D2.Geo.1.K-2 Construct maps & other representations of familiar places

D2.Geo.2.K-2 Use maps/globes to identify characteristics of places ("On the Map")

D2.Geo.4.K-2 How climate & environment affect where plants & people live

NGS Std 1 Use maps & geographic representations

NGS Std 4 Physical & human characteristics of places

NCAS VISUAL ARTS (Tuesday Nature Notebook sketch; Thursday themed art)

VA:Cr1.1.K-2 Generate & develop artistic ideas (observational drawing)

VA:Cr2.1.K-2 Create works of art using materials & tools safely

VA:Cn10.1.K-2 Connect art-making to personal experience, nature & history

NHES HEALTH (Wednesday Kitchen Lab -- safety, rest, hydration, nutrition)
NHES 1 Comprehend concepts related to health (rest, hydration, warm tea)
NHES 4 Use interpersonal communication skills (ask a grown-up for help)
NHES 5 Use decision-making skills (safety: hot water, never taste oils)
NHES 7 Practice health-enhancing behaviors (calm, rest, hygiene, nutrition)

ACTFL WORLD LANGUAGES -- LATIN (Tuesday Latin binomial; Thursday Latin roots)
1.2 Interpretive Communication: understand Latin words & botanical names
2.1 Cultures: practices & perspectives (e.g., Roman uses of the herb)
3.1 Connections: reinforce science/history through Latin
4.1 Comparisons: Latin roots that live on in English (e.g., lavare -> lavender)

CASEL SEL / CHARACTER (Monday character thread; Friday reflection & gratitude)
Self-Awareness * Self-Management * Social Awareness
Relationship Skills * Responsible Decision-Making (care & stewardship)

THE 5-DAY RHYTHM -- STANDARDS THAT RECUR EVERY WEEK
(Each week below applies these to that week's herb, history & geography.)

MON Read-Aloud & Discussion .. ELA: RL.K-2.1/2/3, SL.K-2.1/2/3/6, L.K-2.6;
RF.K-2.4 (verse recitation); CASEL Self/Social-Awareness; Bible (memory verse)
TUE Discovery (botany/senses) . NGSS: 1-LS1-1, K-LS1-1, SEP-3/4/8, Structure&Function;
ELA: SL.K-2.4/5, W.K-2.2, L.K-2.5/6; NCAS VA:Cr1/Cr2; ACTFL 1.2/4.1 (Latin)
WED Kitchen Lab (measure/make) . MATH: K.CC.B.4/5, K.MD.A.1/2, 1.MD.B.3,
2.MD.A.1/C.7;
NGSS: 2-PS1-1, 2-PS1-4, SEP-3; NHES 1/4/5/7; ELA: RI.K-2.3 (steps), L.K-2.6
THU History & Art (map/origins) . ELA: RI.K-2.1/2/3, SL.K-2.2/4; C3: D2.His.1/2/3.K-2,
D2.Geo.1/2/4.K-2 + NGS 1/4; NCAS VA:Cr1/Cr2/Cn10; ACTFL 2.1/4.1 (Latin root)
FRI Garden & Review NGSS: K-LS1-1, 2-LS4-1, K-ESS3-1, SEP-3/4;
MATH: K.CC.B.4/5, K.MD.B.3; ELA: SL.K-2.1/2, RI/RI.K-2.2 (recount), RF.K-2.4;
CASEL Self-Awareness; Bible (verse recap)

YEAR AT A GLANCE - 6 UNITS x 6 WEEKS

Unit 1 (Weeks 1-6) In the Garden God Made Pillar 1: Design

Unit 2 (Weeks 7-12) When Your Body Talks Pillar 2: Signals

Unit 3 (Weeks 13-18) The Way We're Made to Live ... Pillar 3: Tenets

Unit 4 (Weeks 19-24) Handed Down with Love Pillar 4: Lineage

Unit 5 (Weeks 25-30) Just the Way God Made You Pillar 5: Constitution

Unit 6 (Weeks 31-36) Now We Tend the Garden Pillar 6: Practice

Tending Notes

Room to record what worked, what to try next, and how your Sprout is growing.

Tending Notes

Room to record what worked, what to try next, and how your Sprout is growing.

Children learn the body as God's intentional design, one herb at a time.

Inside This Guide

Everything you need to teach the year



- 36 complete weekly plans, laid out day by day.
- Every story, discussion, and kitchen lab, scripted.
- Weekly Scripture, vocabulary, and herb-safety notes.
- No herbal experience needed. Open it and teach.
- About thirty minutes a day. Part of the 6-piece set.

Sprouts K-2

**An Eden Institute
Curriculum**

Eden's Table

Read-Aloud Storybook

Pull up a chair. The year begins as a story.



Stories for the family table

Sprouts K-2

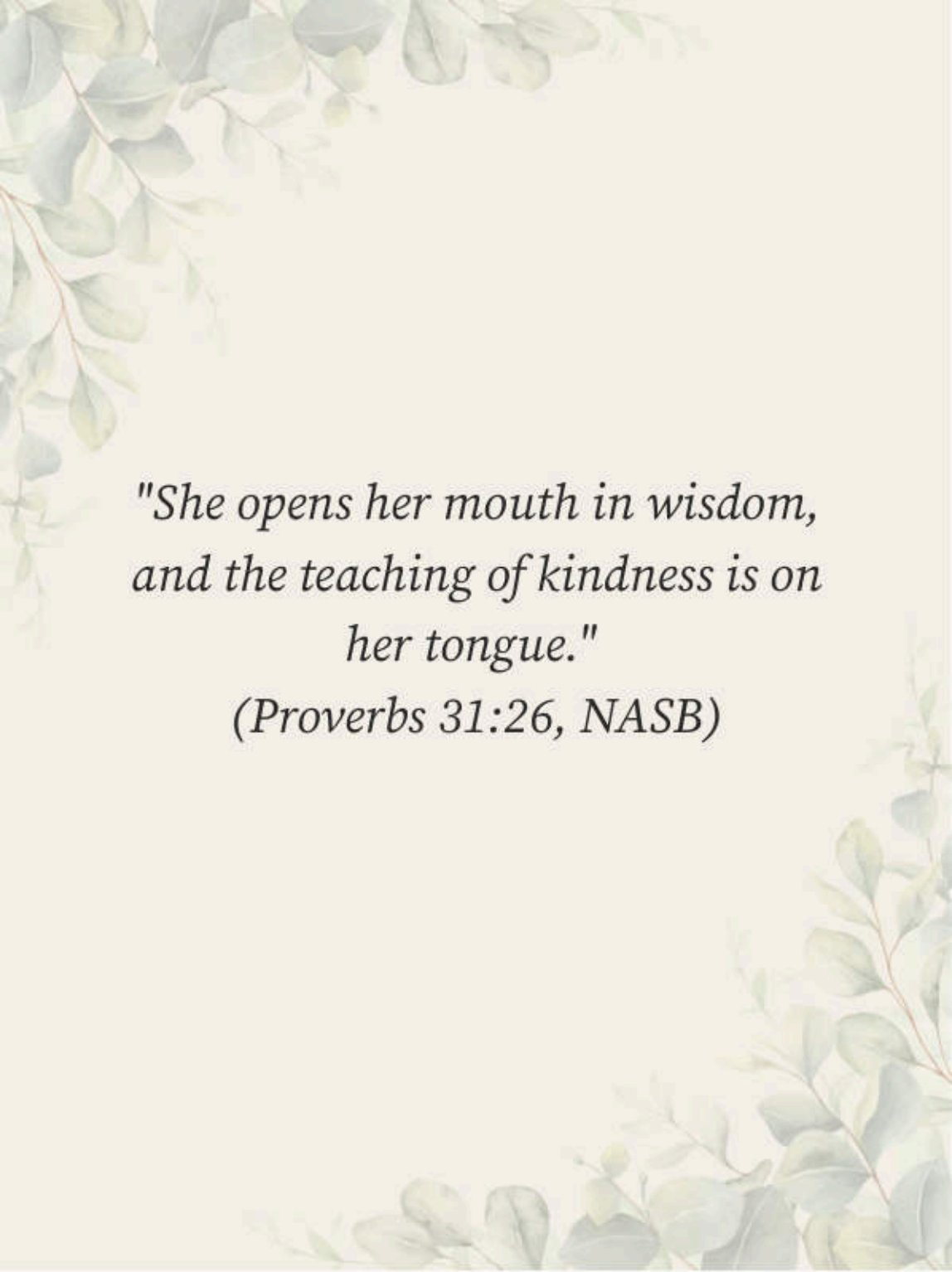
**An Eden Institute
Curriculum**

Eden's Table

*The Read-Aloud Storybook · Sprouts
Stories for the family table.*

*An Eden Institute curriculum, published
by Rooted in Faith Ventures LLC.*





*"She opens her mouth in wisdom,
and the teaching of kindness is on
her tongue."*

(Proverbs 31:26, NASB)

A Note Before You Read

The Eden family isn't make-believe to me. Every one of them came from my own kitchen table.

My husband and I became Vovó and PopPop. My oldest son and his wife became Levi and Ruthie. And my three youngest inspired Manny, Evie, and Gracie. Their character names were even drawn from my children's own middle names, so the people I love most are stitched right into these pages.

But there's something deeper woven in, too. Each member of the Eden family carries a different constitution.

Constitution is the word we use for the wiring God placed inside each of us, the particular way He made you to run. God doesn't make cookie-cutter people. We are each, as Scripture says, fearfully and wonderfully made, and He has left His fingerprint on every one of us in one way or another.

The same is true of the plants. They aren't cookie-cutter either. And when you slow down and study the patterns in people alongside the patterns in plants, you start to see how masterfully they were made to fit together, how a particular plant seems designed to meet a particular person right where they are. That is not an accident. And it's the clearest reminder I know that a one-size-fits-all, cookie-cutter approach to health was never the Designer's plan.

Because God is intentional. He was intentional in how He wired you, intentional in how He shaped every leaf and root, and intentional enough to place the very first family in a garden, back when everything was exactly as it was meant to be. The more you look, the more the whole thing takes your breath away.

So as you read these stories, I hope you'll do two things. Embrace the wiring God breathed into you, every bit of it. And take the time to learn the plants, and how their patterns were made to match yours and bring healing.

For me, this was never just a curriculum. It's my family, the family God entrusted to me, and the greatest honor of my life has been to steward not only their health, but their hearts, and to hand a little piece of that gift to yours.

Turn the page, and come meet the Edens.



Eden's Table Read-A-Loud

A note to the one reading aloud

These stories open the year and mark its turning points. Read each one aloud at the start of its week, before the lessons begin, so the theme arrives first as a story and a friend. Let young children narrate it back to you in their own words, and return to it through the week as a familiar anchor. The Teacher's Guide notes where each story connects to that week's herb and lesson. Read slowly. Let the wonder land.

The family you will meet

You are about to be welcomed into a family that gathers, like yours, around a table. You will meet the children, their parents, and their grandparents, Vovó and PopPop, whose hands know the old ways. Come and sit with them. There is room for you.

Story contents

Story · Title · Read at · Spotlight Herb

Opening · Welcome to the Table (Meet the Family) · Week 1 · (welcome)

One · Life Force · Week 2 · Chamomile

Two · Vovó's Lineage · Week 4 · Peppermint

Three · Symptoms as Signals · Week 7 · Fennel

Four · A Healthy Day · Week 18 · Yarrow

Five · Constitution · Week 25 · Burdock

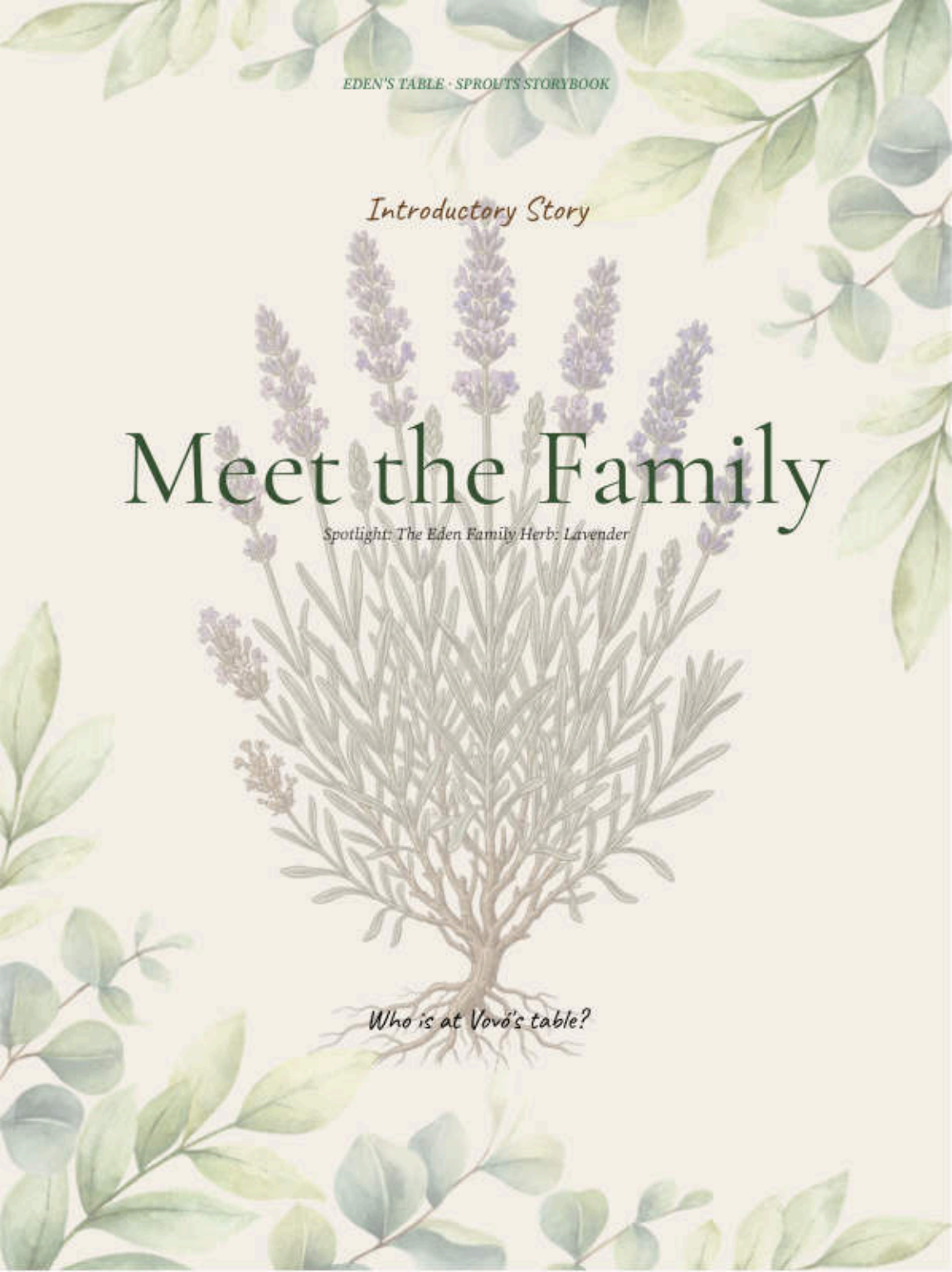
Six · The Buyer Becomes the Teacher · Week 31 · Garlic

Introductory Story

Meet the Family

Spotlight: The Eden Family Herb: Lavender

Who is at Vovo's table?



No one had said grace yet, and Bear had already made his decision about the cornbread.

He was a chocolate goldendoodle roughly the size of a small piece of furniture, and he had stationed himself at the corner of the table where the cornbread sat cooling in its cast-iron pan, wearing the long-suffering expression of a dog who has never once in his life been fed from the table and is certain, any minute now, that today will be the day it changes. His chin was not on the table. His chin hovered one respectful inch above the table, which Bear believed was a different thing entirely. The rules, apparently, did not.

This was the homestead — Vovó and PopPop's place, a white farmhouse at the end of a gravel road outside Clarksville, Tennessee, with a garden out back that was bigger than the house and twice as busy. The whole family came on Sundays. They had come on Sundays for longer than the youngest of them had been alive, which meant that to Gracie, Sundays at the homestead were simply what the world was made of, the same as trees and weather.

Vovó — which means “grandma” in Portuguese, the language her own mother had carried up from Brazil and pressed into her like a seed — was at the stove, barefoot, the way she was nearly always barefoot, moving between three pots with the unbothered authority of a small woman who had cooked this same meal ten thousand times and could do it in the dark if the power ever had the nerve to go out. There was

silver in her hair she had never once considered covering, and she ran her kitchen the way some people run a country. The kitchen, for its part, cooperated. Things were where Vovó's hand expected them to be. They had learned.

She had grown up in two languages and cooked in a third that nobody could name, and when she was warm, or when she wanted you to truly listen, she slipped into the Portuguese her mother had given her — *minha filha*, my girl; *meu amor*, my love.

"Sit," she said — to no one in particular, and therefore to everyone — and the family began, slowly, to sit.

PopPop was already sitting. PopPop was usually already sitting. He had a gift for arriving at the exact center of a room and then becoming, very gently, furniture: present, warm, and in no hurry to prove either. He was a tall Black man gone comfortable in the middle, with long grey dreadlocks he had been growing since before any of the grandchildren were born, and he watched the cornbread situation developing at the corner of the table with the calm of a man who had seen this exact crime attempted many times.

"Easy, Booboo," he said to Gracie, who had her elbow on the table and her eyes locked on the pan. "Good things and cornbread both come to the ones who wait."

"I've been waiting," Gracie said.

"Mm," said PopPop. "Not the same as patient, but it's a start."

Then the door banged, because the door always banged when the rest of them arrived, and the kitchen filled up the way it did every Sunday — all at once, loudly, like weather coming in off a field.

Levi came in first, because Levi came into most rooms first. He was Vovó and PopPop's son, built like his father and quick like his mother, a man who walked fast and talked faster and had opinions the way other people have weather: constantly, and out loud. He kissed Vovó on the top of her head without slowing down, which was the only speed at which Levi did anything tender, and dropped into the chair beside PopPop. "Smells good, Mom." "It is good," said Vovó. "I made it." Levi laughed — he laughed more easily than people expected, the ones who only knew him for the first ten minutes — and he loved hard and argued harder and brought nearly everything, eventually, back around to the Word. Death and life, he liked to say, tapping the table twice, are in the power of the tongue. He believed it completely. He was also still learning to live it, which was a different and slower project.

Ruthie came in behind him, and the room softened half a degree around her without anyone deciding to let it. She

was Levi's wife, Alabama-raised, fair and blonde and blue-eyed, with the kind of good manners that were less about politeness than about a deep unwillingness to take up more room than she had been given. She set a pie on the counter, touched Vovó's shoulder in greeting, and slid into her seat. Ruthie had grown up in a house where health was a thing that happened to you, usually badly and usually without warning, and where the answer to most of it was fear and a waiting room. She had married into a family that thought about all of it completely differently, and she was somewhere in the long middle of changing her mind — not there yet, not nowhere, just on the road. She asked more questions than she answered. Her questions, as it turned out, were usually the ones everyone else was too busy or too certain to ask.

"BIRTHDAY GIRL," announced Manny from the doorway, to Evie, whose birthday it was not.

Manny was seventeen and built like a question mark that had decided to be cheerful about it: tall, lanky, all elbows and warmth, with a smile that arrived a half-second before the rest of him did. He was the oldest of the three and the least likely ever to stop being the baby of any room he walked into. He remembered everybody's birthday, including several that did not exist, and he wanted, more than almost anything, to be a youth minister someday — which surprised no one who had watched him spend twenty minutes making a checkout clerk feel like the most

important person in Tennessee. "It's not my birthday," Evie said. "It's somebody's birthday somewhere," said Manny, folding himself into his chair, "and I like to stay ready." He bumped Gracie's shoulder with his on the way down. Gracie bumped him back harder, on principle.

Manny had been diagnosed with diabetes just the year before, at sixteen — the kind that arrives without warning and does not leave. It had been a hard year, harder than he let most people see; he was still learning the new rules his own body had handed him, and the whole family was learning them alongside him. It had not made him less himself. If anything, it had made him the most attentive person at the table to how a body actually felt from the inside. But that is a longer story, and it belongs to a later one.

Evie had taken the seat in the corner, which was her favorite seat, because from the corner you could see everyone and no one could quite see all of you at once. She was twelve, and soft-spoken, and soft in nearly every other way too — a girl who loved the color pink without apology and apologized for almost everything else, often for things that were in no way her fault. She felt what other people felt a half-step before they felt it, caught their moods the way you catch a cold, and spent a great deal of quiet energy making sure that no one at any table was ever, even slightly, upset. She did not yet know this was a gift. She mostly experienced it as the laugh too."

weather she could not get out of. "I like your braid," she said softly to Ruthie, because she had noticed Ruthie looked tired, and was trying to hand her something good.

And Gracie — Gracie was six, and Gracie was the one with her elbow already on the table and her whole attention already on the cornbread, conducting, at that exact moment, the same delicate negotiation Bear was conducting, with roughly the same odds. She was Vovó's baby and Vovó's project both, a small person made almost entirely of opinions and loyalty. She said what she thought the instant she thought it, valued the truth a good deal more than she valued anybody's feelings about the truth, and held a grudge the way a safe holds money — securely, with no plans to give it back. She also went first through any door she believed one of her people was on the wrong side of. She poked at her brother and her sister without mercy and would have walked through a wall for either of them, and saw no contradiction in this whatsoever.

"Are we eating," Gracie said, "or are we just looking at it."

"We are saying grace," said Vovó, sitting down at last, "and you are going to wait, minha filha, the way the cornbread waited for you."

Gracie folded her arms. "Fine."

They held hands around the table to pray, which was, with this family, a logistical event.

PopPop prayed. He always prayed, slow and unhurried, the same way he did everything — thanking God for the food, and for the hands that grew it, and for the rain that had finally come after making them ask twice. And somewhere in the middle of it, in the warm dark behind everyone's closed eyes, Bear made his move.

It was, by Bear's standards, a masterpiece. He did not lunge; he understood that lunging was for amateurs. He simply leaned — slowly, geologically — until his nose reached the lip of the cast-iron pan, and then attempted to remove one entire square of cornbread with the delicacy of a surgeon and the discretion of a marching band. The pan, which weighed considerably more than Bear had budgeted for, slid. It caught the handle of a spoon. The spoon flipped a respectable arc of green beans into the air, the pan rang against the table like a bell calling a very small church to order, and every head at the table came up at once.

Bear stood frozen with half a square of cornbread in his mouth and a look of profound theological surprise, as though he too could not account for what had happened, as though the cornbread had leapt.

For one held breath nobody moved. Then Manny lost it, and once Manny was gone the whole table went with him —

even Levi, even Gracie, who held out longest as a matter of dignity before folding. "Amen," said PopPop, who had never once stopped, and had prayed clean through the entire disaster with his eyes shut and a small smile he did not bother to hide. "Lord knows we needed

The meal, once it got going, got going the way the family did everything — all at once and overlapping, three conversations and one dog, plates passed the wrong direction, somebody's elbow always in somebody's space. Nearly all of it had come out of the garden behind the house. The greens, the tomatoes, the herbs Vovó had folded into the chicken without announcing them. Ruthie noticed, the way she noticed most things without saying so, that she could not have named half of what she was eating, and that everyone else at the table could.

"How do you know all of it?" she asked Vovó, quietly, between passing dishes. "Every plant out there. What it's for. You never look anything up."

Vovó considered the question with the seriousness she gave to questions that were really about something else. "The same way you know your children's faces," she said. "Somebody put them in front of you, every day, until you did." She did not explain it further than that. She went back to her plate, and let the answer sit where it had landed.

After — while the grown-ups lingered over coffee and Levi got louder and PopPop got quieter, which was their oldest and most comfortable arrangement — Gracie went out to the garden, because the garden was where you went.

It was not a tidy garden. It was a working one: rows and tangles and a fat green riot of things Gracie could only half name. Lavender going gray-purple along the path. Mint staging its yearly invasion of the tomatoes. Something tall and yellow the bees took very seriously. Vovó came out, as she always eventually came out, and walked the rows the way she walked her kitchen — knowing where everything was without looking for it.

"Did you plant all this?" Gracie asked. She asked it most Sundays, and she knew the answer.

"I planted some of it," Vovó said. "My mother planted some of it, in her garden, before mine. And her mother before her." She bent and pulled a weed without appearing to have looked for it. "Somebody put all of this here a long, long time before any of us. We are only keeping it going. Tending it. Watching it. Handing it down."

Evie had drifted out behind them, and Ruthie behind Evie, drying her hands on a towel she had carried outside without meaning to. She stopped at the edge of the garden where it met the grass and watched her two girls follow the small

barefoot woman down the rows, and something in her face was caught halfway between longing and arithmetic — as if she were trying to work out how a person learns a thing like this, and whether it was already too late to begin.

Vovó crouched down to Gracie's height, one hand on her knee. "You want to know the most amazing thing God ever made?" she asked.

Gracie, who had several candidates, weighed them. "Dinosaurs," she offered.

"Close," said Vovó, which made Gracie grin in spite of herself. "No. I think it is you." She tapped Gracie once, lightly, in the center of her chest. "He made you on purpose, every single piece of you. And before you were ever born, He wrote into you everything your body would need to know to take care of itself. You never taught your blood how to close a cut. You never taught your nose what it likes. It is all already in there. Fearfully. Wonderfully. On purpose."

Gracie looked down at her own chest as though she might be able to see in.

"How do you know that?" she asked.

"Because somebody taught me," Vovó said. "The same way I am going to teach you." She straightened, slowly, one hand

pushing off her knee. "All year. A little at a time. Out here, and in there." She tipped her head toward the kitchen, glowing yellow now in the early evening, the men's laughter rolling out through the screen. "The garden and the table. That is the whole school."

At the edge of the grass, Ruthie said it before she could stop herself — quietly, mostly to herself. "I wish I'd grown up knowing any of this."

Vovó did not turn around. "You did not have to grow up with it," she said, "to grow into it." And that was as close to a promise as anyone made that evening — not loud, not underlined, just laid down in the dirt between the lavender and the tomatoes, like a seed somebody trusted to come up on its own.

The sun was dropping behind the tree line. Bear had located the single best patch of late light in the yard and collapsed into it as though the day had asked far too much of him. Inside, somebody started the dishes. And Gracie stood in the middle of a garden her great-great-grandmother had started, in a small fierce body that had been quietly healing her, her whole life, without ever once being asked — and felt, for just a second, before she would have denied it to anyone, the enormous and ordinary wonder of being a person who had been thought of in advance.

She had a whole year of Sundays ahead of her. She did not yet know what was in them.

She was about to find out.

Opening Story: Welcome to the Table (Meet the Family)

God Makes Each Person on Purpose

1. What animal is at the table with the Eden family?

2. Where does PopPop's family go every Sunday?

3. What is Vovó doing when the family arrives?

4. Why does Gracie have her elbow on the table and her eyes on the cornbread?

5. How does PopPop sit? What does that tell you about him?

6. What does Ruthie notice when she looks at what everyone is eating?

7. Vovó says, "Somebody put all of this here a long, long time before any of us." What does she mean? Who put it there?

8. Vovó tells Gracie that God "wrote into you everything your body would need to know to take care of itself." What does that mean?

9. The kitchen and the garden are "the whole school." What do you think Vovó means?

10. If you could ask the Eden family one question over dinner, what would it be?

Story One

Life Force

Spotlight: Gracie · Herb: Chamomile

Why does a cut heal?

Gracie's finger was bleeding and she was not going to cry about it.

She pulled her hand back from the rosebush and looked at it the way she looked at most things that surprised her — with suspicion. A thin line of red was crossing her index finger. It was a very small cut. But it stung, and the fact that it stung when she hadn't done anything wrong did not seem fair.

"It bit me," she announced.

Nobody was in the garden to hear her. Bear was there, but he was busy with something under the basil, and Bear did not count.

She said it anyway. Some things you say out loud even when nobody is listening, and Gracie said most of them.

She pressed her lips together and stared the rosebush down. It did not look sorry. It just kept blooming its small pink flowers — the ones Vovó cut and dried and turned into things that smelled nice — as if it had not just bitten the hand of somebody important. "You're not my friend anymore," Gracie informed it. She was six, and she could hold a grudge against a rosebush, a brother, or a Tuesday, and she would hold this one exactly as long as she pleased.

But she did not cry. Crying was for the sad parts in books — the kind that made Evie cry, though Evie also cried at the

"Your shorts," Vovó said.

happy parts, and most of the parts in between. Gracie loved her sister with her whole fierce heart and did not understand her one bit. She blinked hard, twice, and decided the stinging could be finished now whether it agreed or not.

The blood was small but stubborn, and Gracie respected stubborn. She wiped her finger on her shorts — already the color of everything she did outside — and went to find Vovó.

The kitchen smelled like something green and warm. Vovó was at the counter with her mortar and pestle, grinding something that looked like dried flowers. She didn't look up when Gracie came in.

Vovó almost never looked up when somebody came in. Looking up was for emergencies. Vovó's particular gift was knowing whether something was an emergency without lifting her head — by the sound of the footsteps, by the rhythm of the breathing, by the way the screen door had closed. She had been doing it Gracie's whole life.

"The rosebush bit me."

Vovó set down the pestle. She looked at Gracie's finger, then at Gracie's face, then back at the finger. She took Gracie's hand and held it under the light the way she held everything

she was examining — without urgency, without alarm, just looking.

"Sit," she said.

Gracie sat on the stool. Vovó ran the finger under cool water at the sink, gentle and quick, and pressed a clean cloth against it. Then she just held it there, which was the part Gracie found most confusing. She wasn't doing anything complicated. She wasn't putting anything on it. She was just holding a cloth against a finger and waiting.

Gracie had expected something more. Some ointment. A bandage. A small ceremony, maybe, in which the cut was officially recognized. Instead Vovó just held a cloth against her finger and watched a clock on the wall that Gracie could not see from her stool. The clock ticked. The kettle made its quiet not-yet-boiling sound.

"Is it bad?" Gracie asked.

"No."

"Then why aren't you doing something?"

Vovó looked at her. Something moved through her eyes — not quite a laugh, not quite a smile. Something in between. "Something is already being done," she said. "I am just staying out of the way."

Gracie looked at the cloth. She wanted to check underneath it but Vovó was still holding it, so she couldn't. "How do you know it'll stop?"

"Because your body started before I did." Vovó lifted the cloth just enough to look, then pressed it back. "Right now — without you telling it to, without you thinking about it — your body is building a wall."

Gracie frowned. "A wall."

"Little pieces in your blood. Tiny ones. They are rushing to the cut right now. Stacking themselves up. Making a plug." She said it plainly, the way she said everything, like it was obvious once you knew it. "Your body has been doing this your whole life. Every scratch. Every scrape. You never had to learn it. You never had to ask."

Gracie looked at her finger — or at the cloth covering it — and tried to imagine tiny pieces rushing toward a cut she couldn't see, stacking themselves up on her behalf without any instructions from her. Something happening inside her that she had never known about, that had been happening her whole life.

"Why?" she said.

"Why what?"

"Why does it know how to do that?"

Vovó was quiet for a moment. Not the quiet of someone who didn't know. The quiet of someone letting a question land where it was supposed to land.

In the yard, Bear had abandoned the basil and was making his way toward the open kitchen door with the focused expression of a dog who has decided something is about to happen.

"That," Vovó said, "is the right question."

She made chamomile tea.

Gracie sat at the table with a small bandage on her finger — the cut had already slowed, exactly like Vovó said it would — and watched Vovó move around the kitchen, barefoot on the tile, knowing where everything was without looking. Her hand went to where the chamomile jar was, and the chamomile jar was there. Her hand went to the kettle, and the kettle was there. It was as if the kitchen had agreed with Vovó, a long time ago, to keep its things where her hand expected them.

"Is chamomile for cuts?" Gracie asked.

"No. Chamomile is for the nervous system." Vovó set a mug in front of her. The tea was pale yellow, almost gold. "You are wound up like a spring right now. I can see it in your shoulders."

"Smell it first," Vovó said.

Gracie didn't know she was wound up. She looked at her shoulders. They did seem a little high. She tried to put them down and found that it took actual effort.

Gracie lowered her face toward the mug. Steam rose against her cheeks. The smell was soft and warm and a little bit like hay, but nicer than hay — like the hay had been left in a sunny field and something calm had been added to it.

Her shoulders came down. She hadn't told them to.

"What does it smell like to you?" Vovó asked.

Gracie thought about it seriously. She was not someone who answered questions carelessly. "Like outside. But the good kind of outside."

Vovó made a small sound that was not quite a laugh. "That is a very good answer."

That was when Bear made his move.

He had been standing in the doorway for about forty-five seconds, pretending he was not interested in the mug on the table. He was a terrible pretender. He approached with great dignity, put his chin on the edge of the table, raised his nose over the lip of the mug, and took one long, serious, professional sniff.

Then he sneezed. Not a small sneeze. A sneeze that started somewhere behind his eyes and traveled all the way to his back legs, lifting them slightly off the floor. He looked profoundly surprised. He stared at the mug. He sneezed again. He backed up two steps, reconsidered the mug from a safer distance, and sneezed a third time for good measure.

Gracie laughed. She hadn't meant to — it came out before she could stop it, which was the best kind of laugh.

Vovó did not laugh, but the corners of her eyes did something. "Even Bear's body knows," she said, picking up her own mug, "what it likes and what it doesn't. He did not decide that. His nose told him before his brain could."

Gracie picked up the mug and drank. It tasted like it smelled — warm and gentle and a little like the good kind of outside. Something in her chest, which she hadn't noticed was tight, loosened very slightly.

Later, when the tea was gone and the bandage on her finger had stopped being interesting, Gracie went back to the garden.

The rosebush was still there, completely unbothered, still blooming its small pink flowers. Bear had found his patch of late afternoon sun and was asleep in it, his paws twitching over some dream she would never know about. The chamomile was growing in the corner bed — she could see

the white flowers from where she stood, small and cheerful, shaped like tiny suns.

It was strange, she thought, that the chamomile had been there the whole time. Right there in the corner bed. While she had been bleeding and walking to the kitchen and sitting on the stool, the chamomile had been here, growing, standing patient in the late afternoon sun. It had not known her name. It had not needed to. It had been ready for her for as long as it had been here, which was probably a long time.

She sat on the low stone wall and held out her finger and looked at it. There was a thin pink line where the cut had been. It was not bleeding. It had sealed itself while she was drinking tea and laughing at a dog, and she had not noticed when it happened.

Vovó came and sat beside her. She was carrying a small bunch of chamomile flowers she'd cut from the corner bed — the white ones with yellow centers, each one shaped like it had decided to be a sun and meant it. She put one in Gracie's hand without explaining why.

Gracie held it carefully. The petals were softer than she expected. The flower was very small — smaller than her thumbprint. It did not look like the kind of flower that could do anything important. And yet it had been waiting for her, and for the children before her, and the children before those.

"It's still going," she said. She meant her finger. The quiet aliveness under the skin.

"It will be for a while," Vovó said. "Healing is not one moment. It is many small moments, one after another, most of them invisible. The body does not rush. It does what is needed, in the order it is needed, and it does not stop until it is done."

Gracie turned the chamomile over. She wondered if the plant knew what it could do, or if it just did it the way her body just did it — without being asked, without being told, without needing to understand the reason.

"Vovó," she said.

"Mm."

"Why did God put healing inside people? Why didn't He just make it so we don't get hurt?"

Vovó was quiet. A real quiet, the kind she let go on until it had finished being quiet on its own. "I have thought about that," she said finally. "For many years." She looked at the garden. "I think He put healing inside us for the same reason He put chamomile in the ground. So that when we are hurt, we remember that He thought of this already. Before we were born. Before the rosebush. Before everything."

She put her hand over Gracie's — both of them holding the flower now — and said quietly what she always said when something mattered. "God breathed life into you, minha filha." Her thumb moved once across the back of Gracie's hand. "Your body knows things you never told it."

Gracie didn't say anything. She was looking at the chamomile, thinking about tiny walls and invisible healings, and the fact that something in her had been working on her behalf all afternoon — without being asked, without knowing her name, without stopping.

She had questions now.

The good kind.

Story One: Life Force

Your Body Knows How to Heal

1. What happens to Gracie's finger at the beginning?

2. What does Vovó do when Gracie shows her the cut? (List the steps.)

3. What does Bear do when he smells the chamomile tea?

4. Why doesn't Gracie cry when she gets hurt?

5. Vovó says, "Your body started before I did." What does she mean?

6. Vovó says something is "already being done" even though she's not doing anything complicated. What is happening inside Gracie's body?

7. Chamomile helps the "nervous system." What do you think that means?

(Hint: When you feel worried or tight inside, chamomile helps you feel calm.)

8. The cut healed "all by itself" while Gracie was drinking tea and laughing. Why didn't Vovó have to do anything special?

9. You have a small cut. What does your body already know how to do?

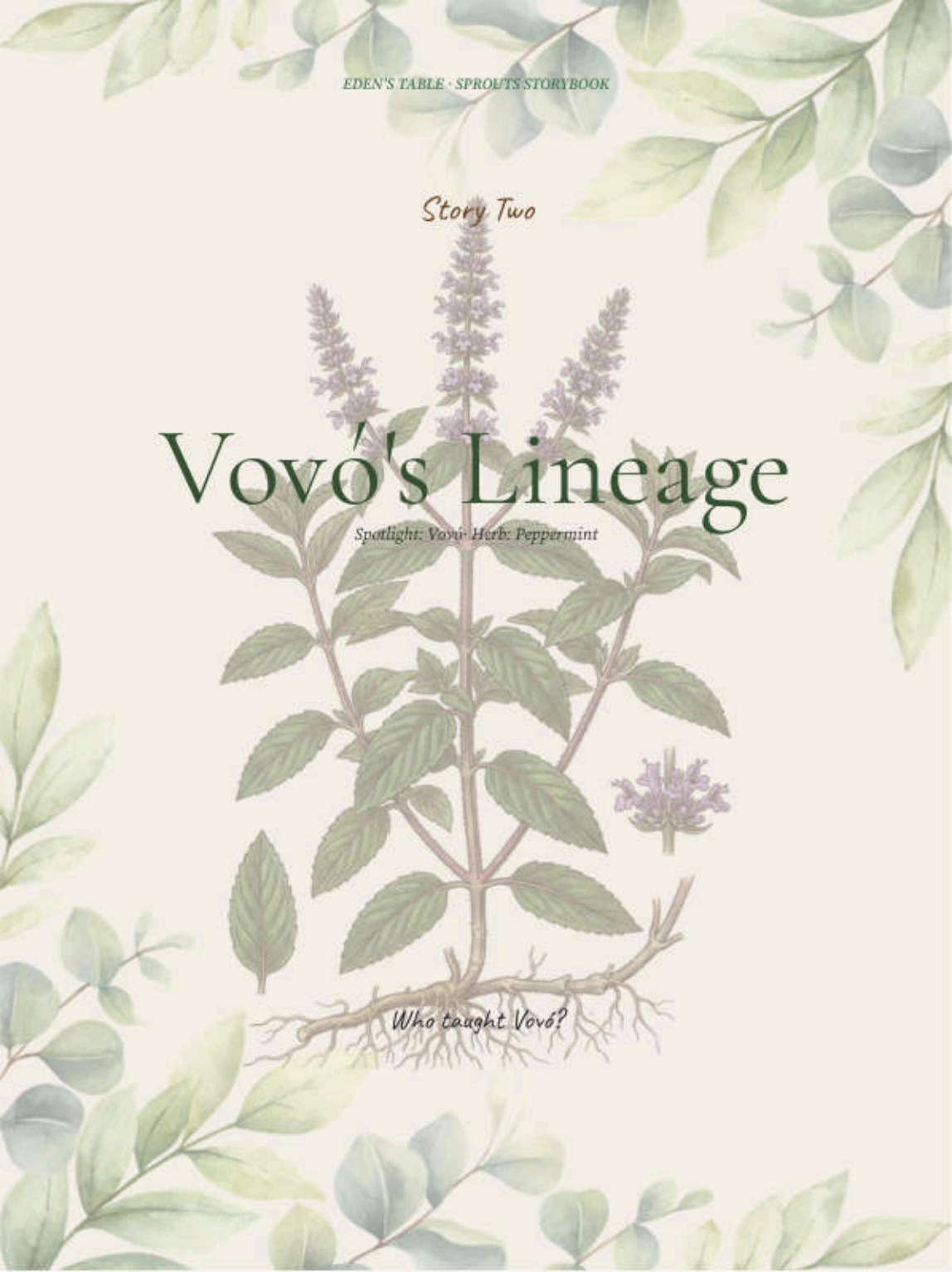
10. Vovó says Gracie's body has been healing her "your whole life" without being asked. Can you think of a time your body did something without you telling it to?

Story Two

Vovó's Lineage

Spotlight: Vovó Herb: Peppermint

Who taught Vovó?



The wooden box was on the high shelf, behind the jars of dried lavender, and Gracie had never seen it before.

She was supposed to be putting away the cleaning rags. She had finished that two minutes ago and was now searching the shelf for the third time, on the theory that something interesting was hidden up there and Vovó had probably forgotten to mention it. This was Gracie's main theory about the kitchen. It had been right at least twice before, which she counted as proof.

The shelf held the things Vovó kept where she could reach and children mostly could not — glass jars of dried herbs in Vovó's careful handwriting, a little clay bowl, a tin with hinges, two old cookbooks with cracked spines. And pushed all the way to the back, so that Gracie had to stand on her toes on the stool to see it: a small box. Dark wood. A tiny brass latch. The kind of box that looks like it is holding something important.

She was not supposed to climb on the stool. She climbed on it anyway, because the box was up there, and the box was clearly the whole point of the day.

The latch was stiff. She worked it open with her thumbnail, and it gave with a small dry click, like it had not been opened in a long time.

Inside was an old photograph, brown around the edges. A young woman stood in a garden with a basket on her hip. The garden looked a little like Vovó's, but smaller, and the sky behind her was not Tennessee sky. It was a brighter blue, the kind that belongs somewhere far away. The woman was barefoot. Her hair was dark. She was holding something green and feathery in one hand.

Gracie squinted. The woman in the photograph looked, in a quiet way, exactly like Vovó. Not her face — the face was young. But the way she stood: one hip out, weight on one bare foot, the basket held like she knew exactly what was in it and what to do with it. Vovó stood like that. Gracie did not, but she was beginning to think that maybe, one day, she might.

"Vovó," Gracie said, climbing down with the photograph. "Who is this?"

Vovó was at the counter, tearing leaves off a fresh green stalk. She did not look up, and she did not look surprised — which Gracie noticed. People who are surprised react. Vovó had not reacted. So the photograph was not a surprise to her.

"Who do you think?" Vovó said.

"Is it you?"

“No. It looks like me, though. Bring it here, minha filha.”

Gracie brought it. Vovó wiped her hands on her apron — twice, palms then backs, the way her hands had done it on their own for years — and held the photograph under the light, without hurry, just looking. Gracie noticed, all of a sudden, how much Vovó's hands looked like the hands in the picture.

“That is Vicentina,” Vovó said. “My grandmother. We all called her Nona.”

Gracie tried to fit the idea in her head. Vovó had a grandmother. Of course she did — everybody who ever lived had a grandmother. But Gracie had never once thought about it, and thinking about it now was a small, quiet earthquake.

“What is she holding?” Gracie asked.

“Peppermint.”

Vovó brought down a green stalk from the bunch she had cut that morning — about as long as Gracie's arm, with neat pairs of leaves running up a square stem. She pinched one leaf off and handed it over. “Smell.”

Gracie smelled it. She was ready for it to smell like a leaf. Instead something bright and cold rushed up her nose and into the back of her head and made her blink twice. The cold went all the way to her eyes — not cold like winter, but like a small clean window had opened inside her face.

“Oh,” she said.

“What does that smell tell you?” Vovó asked, watching.

“Cold,” Gracie said. “And — awake, Waking-up cold.”

“Mm. Now taste it. A small piece.”

Gracie tore a piece and put it on her tongue. The cold happened again, inside her mouth this time, spreading up over the roof of it and out across her cheeks, finding every quiet corner of her head. “It opened up,” she said, before Vovó even asked.

That was when Bear ambled over, drawn by the leaf, and gave it one long, serious, professional sniff. Then he sneezed — an enormous sneeze that lifted his whole front off the floor — backed up two steps, and sat down to watch the leaf from a safe distance, deeply betrayed. Gracie laughed. “Even Bear’s nose knows,” Vovó said. “It told him before his brain could.”

She folded a fresh leaf in her own fingers. "Peppermint helps a hot, tight tummy feel cool and open again, and it wakes a tired head. It cools you on the inside the way a wet cloth cools you on the outside. Your body already knows what to do with it. We are only giving it what it likes."

Gracie nodded slowly. She looked back at the photograph, where Vovó had set it by the cutting board. Nona looked out at her from the past, standing the way she stood.

"Vovó. Who told you about peppermint?"

Vovó rested her hands on the counter. She did not answer right away. She looked at the photograph the way you look at a window when you are remembering something on the other side of it.

"My grandmother taught me," Vovó said. "Nona. When she was a girl, her family ran from the war in Europe and crossed the whole ocean to Brazil — they were half Italian, and they never went back. She grew up there, and she grew old there, and she taught me everything I know."

"Was she nice?" Gracie asked.

"She was the kindest person I have ever known." Vovó said it the way you say a thing you are certain of, in no hurry to prove it. "When I was small, I used to wake up in the dark —

before the birds, before the sun — and the whole house would be black except for one yellow light down in the kitchen. And that light always meant the same thing. It meant Nona was already up. She was always already up.”

Gracie pictured a dark house with one warm window in it.

“I would come down in my nightgown and climb onto a stool in the corner, and I would just watch her,” Vovó said. “She had coffee going and a pot starting, and her hands were always moving — slow, but always moving. She hummed a little while she worked. She did not even know she was humming. And she would cook, and carry, and wash, and cook again, all day long. If you went looking for Nona, you found her in the kitchen. That was where she lived. That was how she loved us. She fed us.”

Vovó picked up the knife from the counter and made a small, slow motion with it in the air, without quite meaning to. “You should have seen the way she cut an onion. So small. Tiny, even pieces, every one the same, like little seeds. It took her forever. I asked her once why she took so long — why she did not just hurry, like everybody else.” Vovó set the knife down softly. “She told me, ‘Because the people I am feeding are worth the time.’”

Gracie sat with that a moment — onions cut as small as seeds, because the people were worth the time.

"She put love into the onions," Vovó said. "She put love into everything her hands touched. And the herbs were right there with the onions — a tea for someone tired, a little mint for a hot tummy. To Nona it was all one thing: the meal, and the medicine, and the love. She never rushed any of it. She lived slow, and gentle, and on purpose. That is where what I know comes from, minha filha. Not from a book. From a woman who got up before the sun, every day of her life, because the people she loved were worth the time."

Vovó looked out the window at the peppermint patch, green in the late light. "I was not like that when I was young," she said, and something close to a laugh moved through her. "I was a hurricane. Loud. Fast. Always halfway out the door, always doing three things at once. But I would watch Nona move so slow and so calm, taking such care, and a quiet part of me wanted to be like her. A part of me still does. I have spent my whole life learning to cut an onion the way she did."

Gracie was quiet a moment. Then, because she noticed things, she said, "PopPop is like that."

Vovó turned and looked at her, and something soft crossed her face. "Like what?"

"He's always helping. But he always thinks he's in the way."

Vovó went quiet — the good kind, the kind she let run until it was finished. “Yes,” she said at last. “That is exactly right. PopPop helps everybody, all day long, and somehow he is always sure he is a bother — always sure he is underfoot. He will fix your whole morning and then say sorry for being there.” She shook her head, smiling. “That is just how Nona was. Always giving. Always certain she was in the way. And both of them wrong about it — because love like that is never in the way.” She looked back at the photograph. “That was the first thing I loved about your PopPop. He reminded me of her.”

“Did Nona give you peppermint when you were little?” Gracie asked.

Vovó's eyes went soft. “She sat me on a stool just like that one,” she said, “and gave me peppermint, just like I gave you.”

Outside, the peppermint patch turned over in the warm wind, a few leaves at a time, so the whole patch seemed to flicker. Gracie looked at it as if for the first time. She had walked past it every day of her life without really seeing it. The peppermint had been there before her. It would be there after her too.

“Vovó,” she said. “When I'm Vovó-old, I'll be in the line too.”

Vovó came and sat on the stool beside her. She did not put her arm around Gracie, because she knew Gracie did not always want that — but their shoulders touched, which counted. It always counted.

Gracie looked at the photograph again. Vicentina. Nona. The bright far-away sky, the basket on her hip, the peppermint in her hand, pale and feathery, looking exactly like the leaf still in Gracie's.

"Will someone find this picture?" Gracie asked. "Someone who comes after me?"

Vovó's hand came up and rested lightly on the back of Gracie's head. Her hand was warm, and it smelled like peppermint and onions and the apron and the long good day. "If you show it to them," she said. She did not say more. She did not need to.

They sat a while. Bear, who had decided the leaf was no longer an insult, came back and lay down with his side against Gracie's ankle. And Gracie thought about the long line of it — Nona rising in the dark, the one yellow light, the onions cut as small as seeds; the same green plant grown for Nona and for Vovó and now for her; each of them knit together on purpose, fearfully and wonderfully made, and loved, and fed. And someday, she understood without being told, there would be someone she had not met yet — someone she would get up early for, and cook for, and put a peppermint leaf into the hand of, the way Nona had for Vovó, and Vovó had for her.

She put the photograph in her pocket. She kept the leaf. She thought about who she might one day show.

Story Two: Vovó's Lineage

The Line of Women Before You

1. What is in the wooden box on the high shelf?

2. Who is Vicentina (Nona)?

3. What plant is Nona holding in the photograph?

4. How does Gracie know Vovó isn't surprised about the photograph? (What gave it away?)

5. Nona "hummed a little while she worked" and "did not even know she was humming." What does that tell you about her?

6. Why did Nona cut onions so slowly and carefully?

7. Peppermint makes your head feel "cold" and "awake." Why would that be helpful if your stomach feels hot and tight?

8. Vovó learned about peppermint from Nona. Where did Nona learn it? (Who taught her?)

9. Gracie thinks, "When I'm Vovó-old, I'll be in the line too." What line is she talking about?

10. Who teaches you things about how to take care of yourself? (It might be a family member, or it might be something else.)

Eden's Table Read-A-Loud

Copyright

Eden's Table, Sprouts Level, Read-Aloud Storybook. Copyright 2026 Rooted in Faith Ventures LLC. All rights reserved. The stories and illustrations are licensed for use by one immediate family. No story or illustration may be reproduced, copied, performed for profit, or distributed without the prior written permission of the publisher. Co-op and group licensing: hello@edeninstitute.health. Part of the Eden Institute family. edeninstitute.health/homeschool. Printed in the USA. Sold direct. No ISBN. Scripture quotations are taken from the New American Standard Bible® (NASB), Copyright © 1960, 1971, 1977, 1995 by The Lockman Foundation. Used by permission. All rights reserved. www.lockman.org

Educational-use Disclaimer

These stories open the year and its turning points with wonder and point young hearts to the Creator. They are for learning and delight, not medical advice. For full safety guidance and the herbal preparations themselves, see the Eden's Table Teacher's Guide.

Meet the family at Eden's Table.

At the end of a garden road lives a family: Vovó and PopPop, Levi and Ruthie, Manny, Evie, and Gracie. (And Bear. There is always Bear.) Around their table, scraped knees meet chamomile and sleepless nights meet lavender, and seven of their stories carry you through the year.

Seven stories carry the year, and the rest of Sprouts grows from them.



- Seven stories, paced across the 36-week year.
- About fifteen minutes to read aloud.
- Written for K-2 hearts, loved by the whole table.
- Read-aloud language, a reach above grade level.
- Written to stretch young readers, not level down.

Sprouts K-2

**An Eden Institute
Curriculum**

Eden's Table

— Student Notebook —

A Biblical, Terrain-Based Herbalism Curriculum



36 Full Weeks

Sprouts K-2

**An Eden Institute
Curriculum**



EDEN'S TABLE - STUDENT NOTEBOOK

Hello, young herbalist!

This is your very own book. Each week you will meet a new plant. You will look at it closely, learn its special name, help make something in the kitchen, and grow a little green thing of your own. You can draw here, write here, and keep what you notice.

God made every plant on purpose, and He made you on purpose too. Let's go to the table and see what we can learn.

My Week

Monday: I listen to a story and a verse.

Tuesday: I look closely and learn five new words.

Wednesday: I help in the kitchen. I follow the safety rules.

Thursday: I learn where my plant comes from, long ago and far away.

Friday: I work in the garden and remember what I learned.

My Herb Safety Rules

Bear, our kitchen friend, helps me remember:

- I always ask a grown-up before I touch, taste, or make anything with herbs.*
- I never pick or taste a plant I find outside.*
- We only use herbs a grown-up bought from a safe place.*
- I tell a grown-up right away if my skin itches, stings, or turns red, or if I feel funny.*
- I wash my hands before and after I work with herbs.*

Notes

Jot down notes and wonderings...

MONDAY

READ-ALoud & DISCUSSION



"And before you were ever born, He wrote into you everything your body would need to know to take care of itself." – Vovó

Smell a sprig of lavender! Your nose just used a sense. In your own words, what do you think "senses" means?

God gave you a body that needs rest, and gave lavender a calm scent to quiet it.

MEMORY VERSE

I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works. Psalm 139:14

Say it together three times.

Which of the Eden family would you most like to meet, and why?

Vovó calls the garden and the table "the whole school" – what will we learn there?

I wonder – God made every part of you on purpose; which part makes you curious?

Lavender

quiets the mind



I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

Psalm 139:14

TUESDAY

DISCOVERY



What does your nose notice first when you rub a lavender bud?

*Draw a lavender spike; label the purple flowers and stem.
Say it: *Lavandula angustifolia* – from lavare, 'to wash'.*

LAVENDER GROWS ON TALL, SLENDER SPIKES OF TINY PURPLE FLOWERS ABOVE GRAY-GREEN LEAVES.

TODAY'S WORD

RELAXING means it helps the body let go and rest. Lavender is relaxing.

Say it together three times.

Lavender has tough, gray-green leaves. Why might a plant from dry, sunny hills grow leaves like that?

Rubbing a dried lavender bud makes its scent stronger. What do you think the rubbing wakes up inside it?

Count the flowers on one lavender spike:
____. On a second spike: _____. Which had
more?

Lavender

quiets the mind



WEDNESDAY

KITCHEN LAB



MAIN INGREDIENTS I USED:

Ingredient 1 and amount: _____

Ingredient 2 and amount: _____

Ingredient 3 and amount: _____

Ingredient 4 and amount: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED:

Color: _____

Smell: _____

Taste: _____

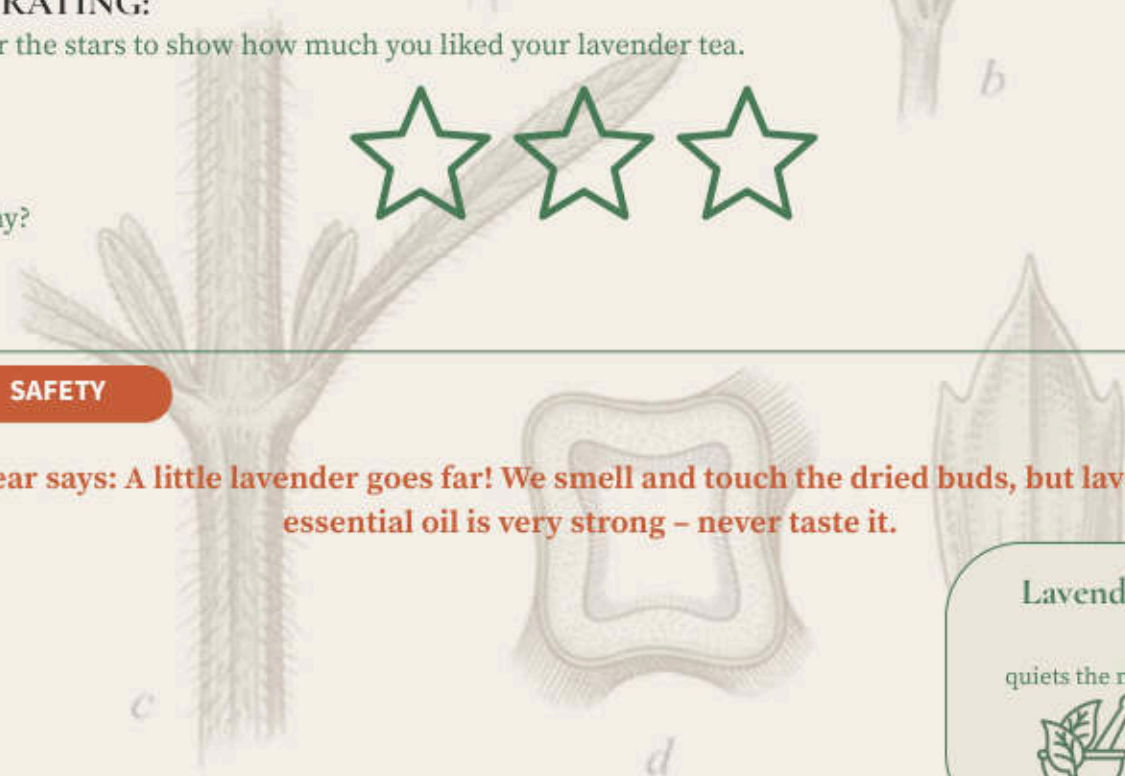
Texture: _____

MY RATING:

Color the stars to show how much you liked your lavender tea.



Why?



SAFETY

Bear says: A little lavender goes far! We smell and touch the dried buds, but lavender essential oil is very strong – never taste it.

Lavender

quiets the mind



LAVANDULA ANGUSTIFOLIA
I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

Psalm 139:14

THURSDAY

HISTORY & ART



Long ago in ancient Rome, the public baths steamed with lavender's fresh, clean scent.

1. Draw three tall lavender stems rising up your page.
2. Climb each stem with rows of tiny purple flowers.
3. Color the slender leaves a soft gray-green.
4. Behind them, add Roman arches and columns.
5. Title it 'Lavender in Rome' and sign your name.

Lavender helps ease tension so your busy body can settle, calm, and rest.

TODAY'S HISTORY

LAVARE means 'to wash,' just what the Romans did with lavender in their baths.

How does today's word fit into the history that you learned?

Who loved to tuck lavender into their baths and laundry to stay fresh and clean?

LAVARE means 'to wash.' What did the Romans wash and freshen with lavender?

Find the Mediterranean Sea and Italy on the map. Lavender loves the warm, sunny, rocky hills of this seaside land.

Lavender

quiets the mind



FRIDAY

GARDEN & REVIEW



"God gave us the scent of rest so we would remember to be still." – Vovó

Find three living things in the garden: a bug, a worm, or a bird. Draw the three you found and write what each one was doing.

A garden is not just dirt and plants; it is full of living things God made, busy all day.

THIS WEEK'S HERB CHANT

Purple flowers calm the day

Sing this week's herb chant in a way that helps you remember it.

How does lavender's calm scent help the body God gave you?

You smelled, brewed, and grew lavender. Which did you like best?

Lavender made its scent before anyone knew why. What does that make you wonder about God?

This week you found the garden full of life. What living thing will you thank God for?

*This week we met lavender, the
calming plant the Romans loved, and
learned that God made our bodies to
rest.*

Lavender

quiets the mind



I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

Psalm 139:14

My Wonder Pages

Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.

MONDAY

READ-ALoud & DISCUSSION



"Your body knows things you never told it." – Vovó

When does your body feel calm and soft, like sleepy chamomile tea? Show me your calmest face!

God gave you skin to care for, and gave chamomile gentle flowers to soothe it.

MEMORY VERSE

I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you. Genesis 1:29

Say it together three times.

Gracie's cut began to heal before anyone helped – how did her body know what to do?

What has mended in you – a scrape, a bruise – without you even noticing?

I wonder, why would God make our bodies able to heal themselves?

Chamomile

calms the body



I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

Genesis 1:29

TUESDAY

DISCOVERY



Look closely at a chamomile flower – what does its middle remind you of?

*Draw a chamomile flower; label the white petals and gold middle.
Say it: Matricaria chamomilla – 'chamomile' means earth apple.*

CHAMOMILE IS A TINY DAISY; WHITE PETALS RING A ROUND, GOLDEN MIDDLE LIKE A LITTLE DOME.

TODAY'S WORD

NERVINE means an herb that calms the nerves. Chamomile is a nervine.

Say it together three times.

Chamomile has white petals around a golden middle. Why might people long ago have called it a 'little sun'?

Chamomile smells sweet, a little like apples. Why do you think a calming herb might smell so gentle?

Line up chamomile flowers across your palm and count them: _____. More or fewer than your fingers? _____

Chamomile

calms the body





MAIN INGREDIENTS I USED:

Ingredient 1 and amount: _____

Ingredient 2 and amount: _____

Ingredient 3 and amount: _____

Ingredient 4 and amount: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED:

Color: _____

Smell: _____

Taste: _____

Texture: _____

MY RATING:

Color the stars to show how much you liked your chamomile tea.



Why? _____

SAFETY

Bear says: Chamomile is gentle, but it is a daisy cousin. If anyone sniffles around daisies or ragweed, check with a grown-up first.

Chamomile

calms the body



THURSDAY

HISTORY & ART



In ancient Egypt by the Nile, people loved chamomile and called it a little sun-herb.

1. Draw a large golden circle for the Egyptian sun.
2. Around it, paint many small chamomile flowers like little suns.
3. Give each white petals around a gold center.
4. Add a Nile-blue border with simple Egyptian patterns.
5. Title it 'Egypt's Sun-Herb' and sign your name.

Chamomile is a gentle herb that calms and steadies you, body and nerves.

TODAY'S HISTORY

A HEALER uses God's plants to help, like Egypt's healers with their chamomile sun-herb.

How does today's word fit into the history that you learned?

In ancient Egypt, what did chamomile's golden center remind people of?

A HEALER helps the body. Who brewed chamomile to calm and comfort the body?

Find Egypt and the Nile River in Africa. Long ago, people there grew chamomile in the warm Nile valley sunshine.

Chamomile

calms the body



FRIDAY

GARDEN & REVIEW



"Even the smallest flower was made to bring us peace." – Vovó

Choose a plant in your yard that is not chamomile. Draw it, then color every shape and shade you notice. What did you spot for the first time?

A gardener's first tool is careful eyes, to notice every color and shape a plant wears.

THIS WEEK'S HERB CHANT

It can calm and soothe us all

Sing this week's herb chant in a way that helps you remember it.

What does chamomile's gentle calm help your body do?

We brewed chamomile and looked closely at a plant. What surprised you?

God gave a tiny flower the power to calm us. What can you thank Him for?

You looked with a scientist's careful eyes. What tiny detail did you never notice before?

*This week we met chamomile, the little
sun-herb the Egyptians loved, whose
gentle flowers help us rest.*

Chamomile

calms the body



I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

Genesis 1:29

My Wonder Pages

Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.

MONDAY

READ-ALoud & DISCUSSION

A joyful heart is good medicine



Our feelings can be bright and happy inside us. Name one thing that cheers you and makes you happy!

God gave you feelings that dip some days, and gave lemon balm a bright scent to cheer them.

MEMORY VERSE

A joyful heart is good medicine. Proverbs 17:22

Say it together three times.

What kinds of things make your heart feel glad and light?

Lemon balm can cheer us a little – where does real, lasting gladness come from?

I wonder – why does God care about a joyful heart, not only a healthy body?

Lemon Balm

gladdens the heart



A joyful heart is good medicine.

Proverbs 17:22

TUESDAY

DISCOVERY



Roll a lemon balm stem: how many flat sides can your fingers feel?

*Draw a lemon balm leaf: label its heart shape and square stem.
Say it: Melissa officinalis – Greek for 'honeybee'.*

LEMON BALM HAS A SQUARE STEM AND HEART-SHAPED, TOOTHED LEAVES THAT SMELL OF LEMON.

TODAY'S WORD

UPLIFTING means it lifts your mood. Lemon balm is uplifting.

Say it together three times.

Lemon balm has a square stem, just like other mints. What does that square stem tell you about its family?

Pinch a lemon balm leaf and it smells like lemon. Why do you think God tucked that bright scent in a leaf?

A square stem has 4 sides. Count the sides on a lemon balm stem: _____. Now count the corners: _____.

Lemon Balm

gladdens the heart





MAIN INGREDIENTS I USED:

Ingredient 1 and amount: _____

Ingredient 2 and amount: _____

Ingredient 3 and amount: _____

Ingredient 4 and amount: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED:

Color: _____

Smell: _____

Taste: _____

Texture: _____

MY RATING:

Color the stars to show how much you liked your lemon balm cordial.



Why?

SAFETY

Bear says: Lemon balm is friendly and safe! Just remember that honey is never for babies under one year old.



Lemon Balm

gladdens the heart



THURSDAY

HISTORY & ART



In ancient Greece, bees adored lemon balm, so the Greeks named it Melissa, 'honeybee.'

1. Draw a Greek honey jar in the middle of your page.
2. Around it, add heart-shaped, toothed lemon balm leaves.
3. Draw a few happy honeybees flying to the leaves.
4. Color the leaves bright green, the bees gold and black.
5. Title it 'Melissa, the Bee Herb' and sign your name.

Lemon balm is a sweet, lemony herb that brightens your mood and cheers your heart.

TODAY'S HISTORY

MELISSA is Greek for 'honeybee,' the name Greeks gave lemon balm because bees love it.

How does today's word fit into the history that you learned?

In ancient Greece, which little creature adored the lemony lemon balm plant?

MELISSA means 'honeybee.' Why did the Greeks give lemon balm that name?

Find Greece on the map, across the
Mediterranean Sea. Lemon balm grows wild on
its sunny hillsides, loved by bees.

Lemon Balm

gladdens the heart



FRIDAY

GARDEN & REVIEW



"A glad heart is good medicine - and God grows it in the garden." - Vovó

With your eyes closed, feel three different leaves in the garden. Guess if each is smooth, fuzzy, or waxy. Draw your favorite one to touch.

Plants wear all kinds of skins, smooth, fuzzy, waxy, and prickly, for gentle hands to feel.

THIS WEEK'S HERB CHANT

Gladdest leaf you've ever seen

Sing this week's herb chant in a way that helps you remember it.

How does lemon balm's lemony cheer lift your spirits?

The Greeks named it 'Melissa' for the bees. Why do bees and people love it?

A joyful heart is good medicine. What fills your heart with gladness?

You felt smooth, fuzzy, and prickly leaves. Which was your favorite to touch, and why?

*This week we met lemon balm, the
bee-loved herb of Greece, whose
lemony cheer gladdens our hearts.*

Lemon Balm

gladdens the heart



A joyful heart is good medicine.

Proverbs 17:22

The image shows a full-page layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, there is a dark green banner with the title "My Wonder Pages" in a white, serif font. Below the title, in a smaller white font, is the instruction "Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found." The main body of the page is cream-colored and features 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is decorated with watercolor-style illustrations of green leaves and branches, which are visible along the top, bottom, and right edges. In the bottom right corner, the page number "20" is printed in a small, dark font.

MONDAY

READ-ALoud & DISCUSSION



"When I'm Vovó-old, I'll be in the line too." - Gracie

A grumbly tummy and a calm tummy are opposites! How does your tummy feel when cool peppermint says hello?

God gave you a tummy, and made peppermint cool and bright to settle it when it's busy.

MEMORY VERSE

It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones. Proverbs 3:8

Say it together three times.

Nona taught Vovó in the kitchen - who has taught you something good?

Vovó made peppermint tea to help her family feel better. How do people in your home show they care when someone feels sick?

I wonder, why might God pass His gifts from grandparents to grandchildren?

Peppermint

settles the tummy



It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones.

Proverbs 3:8

TUESDAY

DISCOVERY



After you smell peppermint, why might your nose feel cool inside?

Draw a peppermint leaf; label its teeth and stem.
Say it: *Mentha x piperita* – the x means a hybrid mint.

PEPPERMINT HAS TOOTHED GREEN LEAVES AND A COOL SCENT FROM THE MENTHOL IT MAKES.

TODAY'S WORD

CARMINATIVE means it soothes a gassy tummy. Peppermint is a carminative.

Say it together three times.

Peppermint has a purple-tinged stem and toothed leaves. Which part helps you tell it apart from other plants?

When you crush a peppermint leaf, the air feels cool. Where do you think that surprising cool comes from?

Count the little teeth along one peppermint leaf: _____. Count a second leaf: _____. Which had more?

Peppermint

settles the tummy





MAIN INGREDIENTS I USED:

Ingredient 1 and amount: _____

Ingredient 2 and amount: _____

Ingredient 3 and amount: _____

Ingredient 4 and amount: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED:

Color: _____

Smell: _____

Taste: _____

Texture: _____

MY RATING:

Color the stars to show how much you liked making your peppermint compress.



Why?

SAFETY

Bear says: Peppermint is cool and strong! Keep a compress off the eyes and face. Peppermint essential oil is very strong.

Peppermint

settles the tummy



THURSDAY

HISTORY & ART



In England, the town of Mitcham grew the world's most famous peppermint.

1. Draw a wide English field stretching to the horizon.
2. Fill it with long rows of green peppermint plants.
3. Add a little village and a cart for the harvest.
4. Color it all cool green under a soft blue sky.
5. Title it 'The Mint Fields of Mitcham' and sign your name.

Peppermint helps soothe a gassy, bubbly tummy and cool you down.

TODAY'S HISTORY

MITCHAM was the English town whose green fields grew the world's most famous peppermint.

How does today's word fit into the history that you learned?

What did the English town of Mitcham grow that was the finest in all the world?

MITCHAM was famous for peppermint. How did whole families cut the plants at harvest?

Find England, and the town of Mitcham near London. Its cool, damp fields once grew the world's most famous peppermint.

Peppermint

settles the tummy



FRIDAY

GARDEN & REVIEW



"God made the cool and the warm, and both are a kindness." – Vovó

Rub and smell three garden plants, peppermint plus two others. Draw the one you liked best and label its smell: sweet, sharp, or fresh.

God tucked a scent inside so many plants, some strong, some soft, each one its own.

THIS WEEK'S HERB CHANT

Settles tummies, calm and clean

Sing this week's herb chant in a way that helps you remember it.

When your tummy feels uneasy, how can cool peppermint help?

You felt peppermint's cool, then a cool compress. Where did the cool come from?

Peppermint is a hybrid of two mints. What does that make you wonder about God?

You smelled many garden plants. Which scent would you want to keep close by?

*This week we met peppermint, the cool
mint of Mitcham's famous fields,
whose fresh menthol settles a busy
tummy.*

Peppermint

settles the tummy



It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones.

Proverbs 3:8

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, there is a dark green header with the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of green leaves and branches, which are positioned along the top, right, and bottom edges, framing the central writing area.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, there is a dark green header with the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of green leaves and branches, which are positioned along the top, right, and bottom edges, framing the central writing area.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, there is a dark green header with the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of green leaves and branches, which are positioned along the top, right, and bottom edges, framing the central writing area.

MONDAY

READ-ALoud & DISCUSSION



He heals the brokenhearted

Your epidermis is the skin you can see and touch! Point to your epidermis as a soft calendula petal tickles it.

God gave you skin that gets bumped, and gave calendula golden petals to soothe it.

MEMORY VERSE

He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds. Psalm 147:3

Say it together three times.

God binds up our wounds – who heals the hurts we cannot see?

A bandage helps the outside; what hurt can only God reach?

I wonder – why did God give calendula such gentle care for our skin?

Calendula

soothes the skin



He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

Psalm 147:3

TUESDAY

DISCOVERY



Why might God have given calendula such a bright, sunny gold?

Draw a calendula bloom; label its many gold petals.

Say it: Calendula officinalis – from 'calendar' – blooms for months.

CALENDULA HAS MANY SLIM GOLD AND ORANGE PETALS, LAYERED, ON A FAINTLY STICKY STEM.

TODAY'S WORD

VULNERARY means it comforts the skin. Calendula is a vulnerary.

Say it together three times.

Calendula opens its petals to the sun and shuts them under clouds. Why might a flower do that?

Calendula's stem feels a little sticky with resin. What do you think that sticky resin might be for?

Count 10 calendula petals by 2s: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10. Point to each one as you count.

Calendula

soothes the skin



WEDNESDAY

KITCHEN LAB



MAIN INGREDIENTS I USED:

Ingredient 1 and amount: _____

Ingredient 2 and amount: _____

Ingredient 3 and amount: _____

Ingredient 4 and amount: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED:

Color: _____

Smell: _____

Taste: _____

Texture: _____

MY RATING:

Color the stars to show how much you liked making your calendula dressing.



Why? _____

SAFETY

Bear says: Calendula is a gentle daisy cousin! Use it only on clean, small scrapes – never a deep cut. Check first if daisies or ragweed bother you.

Calendula

soothes the skin



He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

Psalm 147:3

THURSDAY

HISTORY & ART



In the Middle Ages, monks grew calendula and lovingly called its bloom 'Mary's gold.'

1. Draw one calendula bloom large in the center.
2. Fill it with many thin gold and orange petals.
3. Frame it with a fancy medieval-manuscript border.
4. Add gold dots and curls in the corners.
5. Title it 'Mary's Gold' and sign your name.

Calendula, the orange flower, comforts and supports your skin after little scrapes.

TODAY'S HISTORY

MARIGOLD means 'Mary's gold,' the name medieval monks gave calendula's golden bloom.

How does today's word fit into the history that you learned?

In the Middle Ages, who grew calendula in their garden beds for soothing the skin?

MARIGOLD comes from 'Mary's gold.' What tender nickname did people give calendula?

Find southern Europe on the map. Calendula came from these warm Mediterranean lands and bloomed in medieval gardens.

Calendula

soothes the skin



He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

Psalm 147:3

FRIDAY

GARDEN & REVIEW



"The same hands that mend our skin are mending our hearts." – Vovó

Stand still by a plant for two minutes. Watch for a visitor, a bee, an ant, or a bird. Draw the one you saw and tell what it was doing.

A quiet watcher sees the garden's secrets, the bees, birds, and bugs that visit all day.

THIS WEEK'S HERB CHANT

Soothes a scrape and calms the skin

Sing this week's herb chant in a way that helps you remember it.

How does calendula support your skin after a small scrape?

We steeped calendula's petals into a soothing dressing. How can one little flower give such gentle care?

God binds up wounds and gave us calendula for our skin. What does that show about His care?

You stood still and watched. Which garden visitor was your favorite to see?

*This week we met calendula, the
'Mary's gold' of medieval gardens,
whose golden petals soothe our skin.*

Calendula

soothes the skin



He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

Psalm 147:3

The image shows a full-page spread of a notebook or journal. The top and bottom edges are decorated with a dark green banner featuring a pattern of various green leaves. The central area of the page is white and contains 20 horizontal green lines for writing, arranged in two columns of ten. The page number '32' is printed in a small, dark font in the bottom right corner.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, a dark green banner contains the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, elegant serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text in a simple sans-serif font reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing, arranged in two columns of ten. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of various green leaves and branches, which are scattered along the top, bottom, and right edges, creating a natural and artistic feel.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, a dark green banner contains the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, elegant serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text in a simple sans-serif font reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of various green leaves and branches, which are scattered along the top, bottom, and right edges, creating a natural and artistic feel.

MONDAY

READ-ALoud & DISCUSSION

Blessed are the gentle



Your skin is a guard wall that keeps trouble out. How might leafy plantain help your skin after a bug gets past the guard?

God gave you skin that meets the world, and gave plantain broad leaves to comfort it.

MEMORY VERSE

Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth. Matthew 5:5

Say it together three times.

Jesus blesses the gentle – what does it mean to be gentle?

Why would God hide a real gift inside a small, humble weed?

I wonder – what gifts has God tucked into the plants we walk past?

Plantain

draws the sting



Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

Matthew 5:5

TUESDAY

DISCOVERY



Run a finger along a plantain leaf – what ridged lines do you feel?

Draw a plantain leaf; label its parallel veins.

Say it: Plantago major – planta, 'sole of the foot'.

PLANTAIN IS A LOW, BROAD-LEAVED PLANT WHOSE STRONG VEINS RUN SIDE BY SIDE, BASE TO TIP.

TODAY'S WORD

DRAWING means it draws out a sting or splinter. Plantain is a drawing herb.

Say it together three times.

Plantain grows right where people walk and step. How does such a soft little plant survive being stepped on?

Pull a plantain leaf apart and you see strong, string-like veins. What do you think those strong veins do?

Count the strong veins on one plantain leaf: _____. Count a bigger leaf: _____. Which had more?

Plantain

draws the sting



WEDNESDAY

KITCHEN LAB



MAIN INGREDIENTS I USED:

Ingredient 1 and amount: _____

Ingredient 2 and amount: _____

Ingredient 3 and amount: _____

Ingredient 4 and amount: _____

WHAT I OBSERVED:

Color: _____

Smell: _____

Taste: _____

Texture: _____

MY RATING:

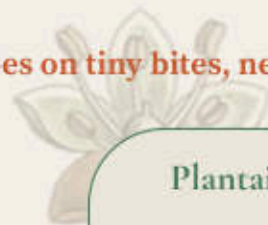
Color the stars to show how much you liked making your plantain poultice.



Why?

SAFETY

Bear says: Use only clean, unsprayed plantain! A poultice goes on tiny bites, never a deep cut. Ask a grown-up to pick it.



Plantain

draws the sting



Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

Matthew 5:5

THURSDAY

HISTORY & ART



Long ago the Anglo-Saxons treasured plantain, naming it 'waybread' for the paths it lo

1. Draw a winding path across your page.
2. Along its edges, add low plantain with broad leaves.
3. Show the strong veins running up each leaf.
4. Color the leaves green, the path brown and gray.
5. Title it 'Waybread by the Path' and sign your name.

Crushed on the skin, plantain helps draw out a sting or splinter.

TODAY'S HISTORY

WAYBREAD is the Anglo-Saxon name for plantain, the plant that springs up along the paths.

How does today's word fit into the history that you learned?

What name did the Anglo-Saxons give plantain because it grew along the paths?

WAYBREAD means the plant of the 'ways.' What are the 'ways' where plantain grew?

Find Europe and Asia on the map – plantain's first home. Today it follows people's paths on almost every continent!

Plantain

draws the sting



FRIDAY

GARDEN & REVIEW

"God hides His best gifts in humble places – look down, meu amor." – Vovó



Find one small garden creature: a worm, a beetle, or a ladybug. Watch it gently, then draw it and give it a kind name.

A garden is home to worms, bugs, and birds God made to share it, so we tend them gently.

THIS WEEK'S HERB CHANT

Draws the sting and saves the day

Sing this week's herb chant in a way that helps you remember it.

How does a humble plantain leaf support your skin?

You found plantain by the path, then made a poultice. Why grow a helper where people walk?

Jesus blessed the lowly. What makes you wonder that God hid help in a weed?

You met a garden creature up close. How can you be gentle with the small ones God made?

*This week we met plantain, the
humble 'waybread' of the paths,
whose broad leaves comfort our skin.*

Plantain

draws the sting



Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

Matthew 5:5

The image shows a full-page spread of a notebook or journal. The top and bottom edges are decorated with a dark green banner featuring a pattern of various green leaves. The central area of the page is white and contains 20 horizontal green lines for writing, arranged in two columns of ten. The page number '38' is printed in a small, dark font in the bottom right corner. The overall aesthetic is natural and botanical.

The image shows a full-page spread of a notebook or journal. The top and bottom edges are decorated with a dark green banner featuring a pattern of various green leaves. The central area of the page is white and contains 20 horizontal green lines for writing, arranged in two columns of ten. The page number '38' is printed in a small, dark font in the bottom right corner.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, a dark green header contains the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, elegant serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text in a white sans-serif font reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of various green leaves and branches, which are scattered along the top, bottom, and right edges, creating a natural and artistic border.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout for a journal or notebook. At the top, a dark green header contains the title 'My Wonder Pages' in a white, elegant serif font. Below the title, a smaller line of text in a white sans-serif font reads 'Draw and write the plants you met and the wonders you found.' The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of various green leaves and branches, which are scattered along the top, bottom, and right edges, creating a natural and artistic border.

The image shows a full-page decorative layout. At the top is a dark green header with the word "Notes" in a white serif font, and below it, the phrase "Jot down notes and wonderings..." in a smaller white sans-serif font. The main body of the page is cream-colored and contains 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is framed by delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of green leaves and branches. These illustrations appear along the top edge (under the header), the right edge, and the bottom edge, creating a natural, organic feel. The bottom right corner of the page features the page number "219" in a small, dark green serif font.

The image shows a full-page decorative template for notes. At the top, a dark green header bar contains the word "Notes" in a white serif font, with the subtitle "Jot down notes and wonderings..." in a smaller white sans-serif font below it. The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate illustrations of green leaves and branches, which frame the top, right, and bottom edges. The bottom right corner of the page displays the page number "219" in a dark green serif font.

The image shows a full-page decorative template for notes. At the top, a dark green header bar contains the word "Notes" in a white serif font, with the subtitle "Jot down notes and wonderings..." in a smaller white sans-serif font below it. The main body of the page is a light cream color, filled with horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate illustrations of green leaves and branches, which frame the top, right, and bottom edges. The bottom right corner of the page features the page number "219" in a small, dark green serif font.

Notes

Jot down notes and wonderings...

The image shows a full-page decorative template for notes. At the top, a dark green header bar contains the word "Notes" in a white serif font, with the subtitle "Jot down notes and wonderings..." in a smaller white sans-serif font below it. The main body of the page is a light cream color, featuring 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is adorned with delicate illustrations of green leaves and branches, which frame the top, right, and bottom edges. The bottom right corner of the page displays the page number "221" in a small, dark font.

The image shows a full-page decorative template for a notebook. At the top, there is a dark green header bar. Inside this bar, the word "Notes" is written in a large, white, serif font. Below it, in a smaller, white, sans-serif font, is the phrase "Jot down notes and wonderings...". The main body of the page is a light cream color and is filled with horizontal green lines for writing. The page is decorated with delicate illustrations of green leaves and branches. These illustrations are located in the top right corner, along the right edge, and along the bottom edge. The overall aesthetic is clean, modern, and nature-inspired.

The image shows a full-page decorative template. At the top is a dark green header with the word "Notes" in a white serif font, and below it, the phrase "Jot down notes and wonderings..." in a smaller white sans-serif font. The main body of the page is cream-colored and contains 20 horizontal green lines for writing. The page is framed by delicate, watercolor-style illustrations of green leaves and branches. These illustrations appear along the top edge (under the header), the right edge, and the bottom edge, creating a natural, organic feel. The bottom right corner of the page features the page number "221" in a small, dark green font.

Notes

Jot down notes and wonderings...

Notes

Jot down notes and wonderings...

EDEN'S TABLE - STUDENT NOTEBOOK

Copyright

Eden's Table, Sprouts Level, Student Notebook. Copyright 2026 Rooted in Faith Ventures LLC. All rights reserved. This Student Notebook is licensed for the children of one immediate family. It may not be photocopied or reproduced; additional copies are sold separately, one per child. Co-op and group licensing: hello@edeninstitute.health. Part of the Eden Institute family. edeninstitute.health/homeschool. Printed in the USA. Sold direct. No ISBN. Scripture quotations are taken from the New American Standard Bible (NASB), Copyright © 1960, 1971, 1977, 1995 by The Lockman Foundation. Used by permission. All rights reserved. www.lockman.org

A note for parents

This Notebook is for learning about herbs, not for medical advice. Nothing here is meant to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any illness, and it is not a substitute for professional care. Before giving your child any herb by mouth or applying any herb to the skin, especially during pregnancy or nursing or alongside medication, consult a qualified healthcare provider. The full safety guidance is in the Teacher's Guide; please read it before you begin.

About Eden's Table

Eden's Table is a curriculum of the Eden Institute family, helping families care for the body as good stewards under God. edeninstitute.health/homeschool.

This year, God's garden is your
classroom.

36 Weeks of Wonder

Here is what you will do this year



- You will meet 36 herbs, one every week.
- You will taste, smell, and touch real plants.
- You will draw what you discover.
- You will make real recipes in your kitchen.
- You will learn a chant for every herb you meet.

Sprouts K-2

**An Eden Institute
Curriculum**

*CHANT: the herb's four-line song,
sung all week. Flip to the card and
the verse cues your memory: see the
plant, sing the song, recall the
herb. (Music · Memory · LA)*

*A scientifically accurate illustration
on every card, so your child can
spot the real plant in the garden,
on the trail, or at the market.
That's why they're Field Cards.*

Common name of the herb

Scientific (Latin) name used by botanists everywhere

Older Latin name (some plants have two)

Plant family: kinship to other plants (mints, daisies, roses)

Common name (large) — visual locator

Latin name: builds recall on every flip

Herbal Actions

ACTIONS: the three ways this herb works: its herbal action (nervine, carminative, astringent), warming or cooling, and drying or moistening. The way a real herbalist reads a plant. (Science · Health)

Taste

TASTE: what the herb tastes like (bitter, sweet, pungent, sour, salty, astringent), plus something you already know it tastes like. Taste is the oldest way herbalists knew what a plant does. (Science · Health)

Identify by

How to spot this plant in the wild. Square stem? Opposite leaves? Distinct scent? Children become real plant identifiers. Used on hikes, in gardens, at markets. (Subjects: Science / botany)

Caution

CAUTION: the herb's main contraindication, the one warning that matters most, straight from the materia medica. Real risk language, not childproofed away. (Science · Health)

A detailed botanical illustration of a lavender plant. The plant has a woody base with several upright, branched stems. The leaves are small, narrow, and green, growing in opposite pairs along the stems. At the top of the stems are clusters of small, purple flowers. The background is a light, neutral color, and the overall style is soft and artistic.

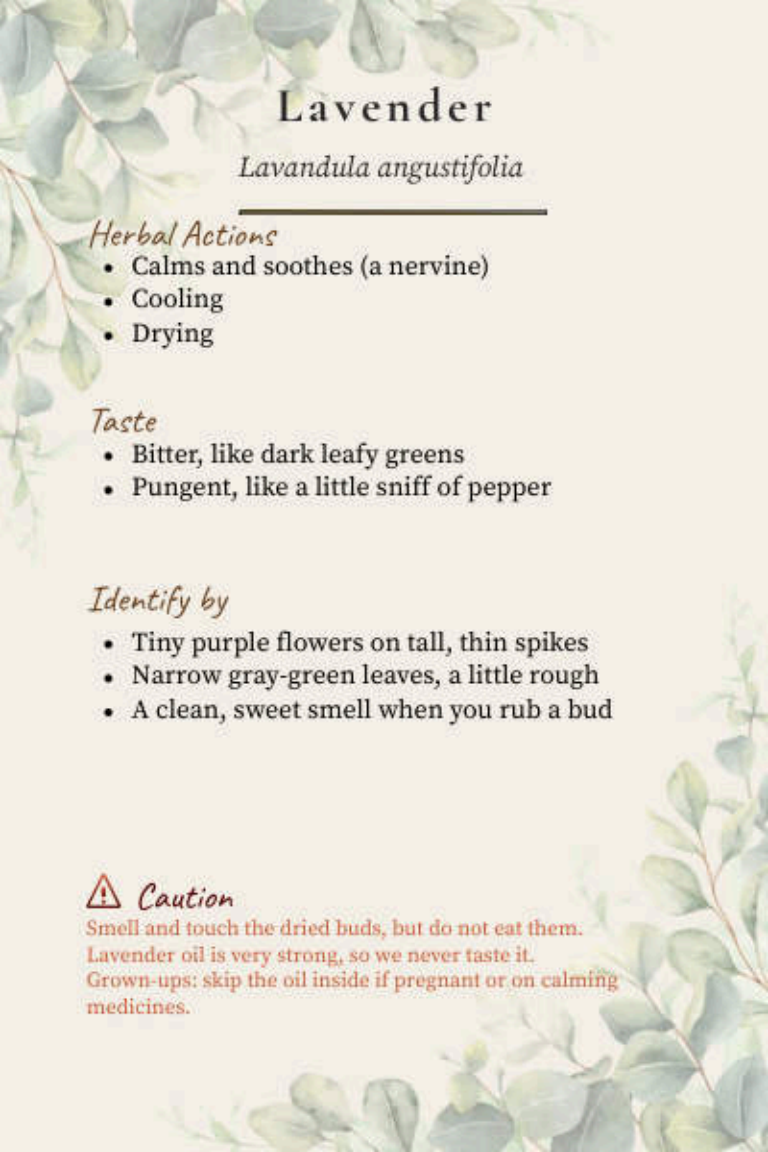
Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away

Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Lavandula officinalis

Lamiaceae

A detailed botanical illustration of a lavender plant, showing its characteristic silvery-green, rounded leaves and thin, woody stems. The plant is depicted in a soft, painterly style, with some leaves in sharp focus and others blurred in the background, creating a sense of depth. The overall color palette is muted greens and greys, typical of lavender foliage.

Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Herbal Actions

- Calms and soothes (a nervine)
- Cooling
- Drying

Taste

- Bitter, like dark leafy greens
- Pungent, like a little sniff of pepper

Identify by

- Tiny purple flowers on tall, thin spikes
- Narrow gray-green leaves, a little rough
- A clean, sweet smell when you rub a bud

Caution

Smell and touch the dried buds, but do not eat them.

Lavender oil is very strong, so we never taste it.

Grown-ups: skip the oil inside if pregnant or on calming medicines.



Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child

Chamomile (German)

Matricaria chamomilla

Matricaria recutita

Asteraceae

Chamomile (German)

Matricaria chamomilla

Herbal Actions

- Calms and soothes (a nervine)
- Cooling
- Drying

Taste

- Bitter, like dark leafy greens
- Sweet, like a little honey

Identify by

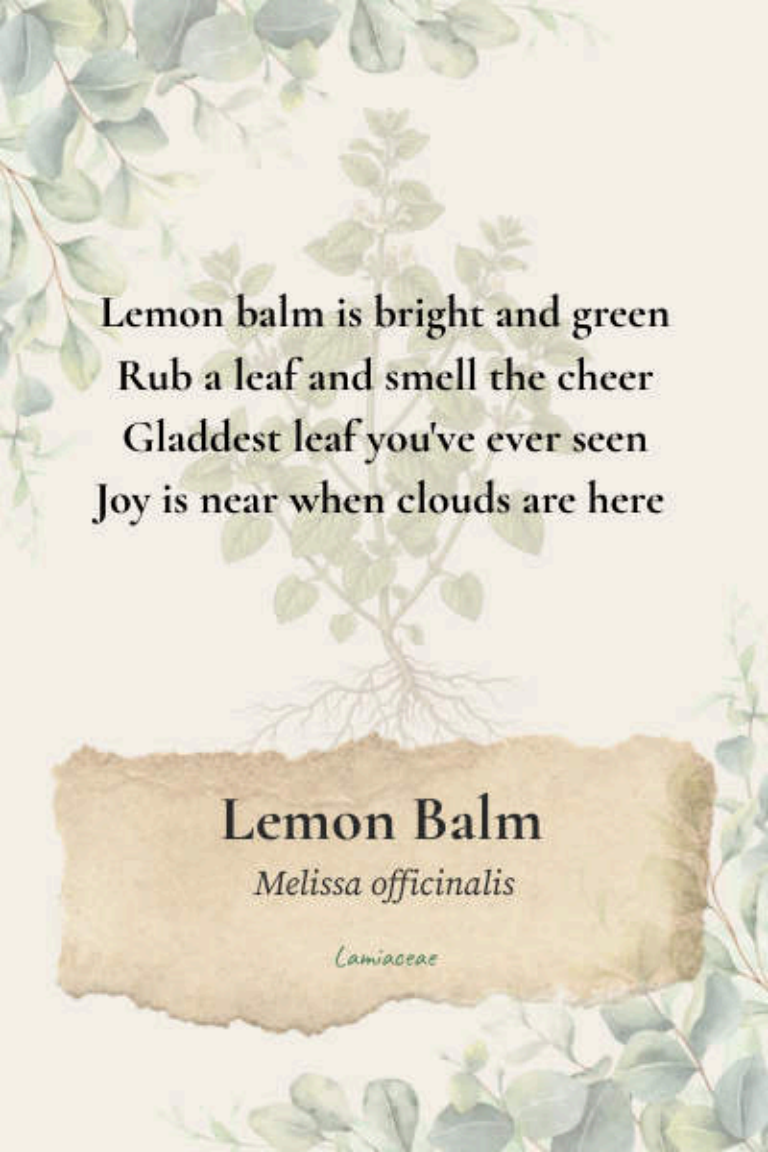
- Small flower with white petals around a gold dome
- Smells sweet, like a little apple
- Light, papery petals on a tiny flower head

Caution

Chamomile is a daisy cousin.

If you sniffle around daisies or ragweed, ask a grown-up first.

Grown-ups: ask a doctor if you take blood-thinner medicine.



Lemon balm is bright and green
Rub a leaf and smell the cheer
Gladdest leaf you've ever seen
Joy is near when clouds are here

Lemon Balm

Melissa officinalis

Lamiaceae



Lemon Balm

Melissa officinalis

Herbal Actions

- Calms a worried mind (a nervine)
- Cooling
- Drying

Taste

- Sour, like a squeeze of lemon
- Sweet, like a sip of honey water

Identify by

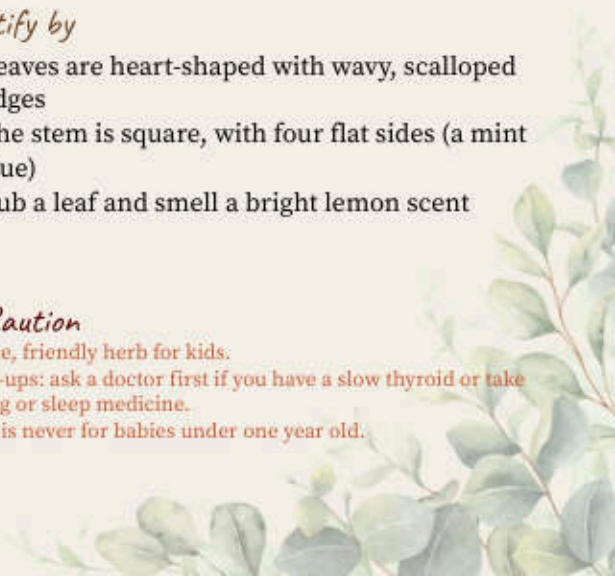
- Leaves are heart-shaped with wavy, scalloped edges
- The stem is square, with four flat sides (a mint clue)
- Rub a leaf and smell a bright lemon scent

Caution

A gentle, friendly herb for kids.

Grown-ups: ask a doctor first if you have a slow thyroid or take calming or sleep medicine.

Honey is never for babies under one year old.



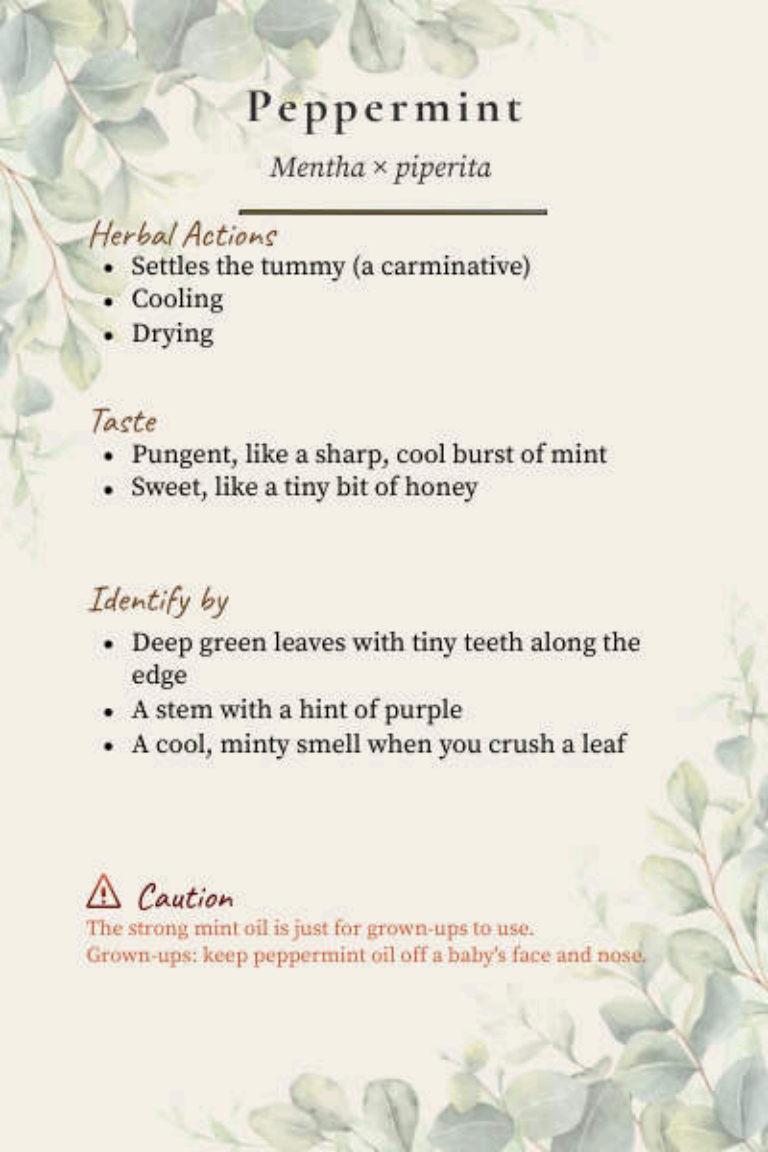


Peppermint is cool and bright
Settles tummies, calm and clean
Minty fresh and frosty light
Freshest leaf you've ever seen

Peppermint

Mentha × piperita

Lamiaceae

A decorative background featuring soft, watercolor-style illustrations of peppermint leaves. The leaves are a pale, muted green with visible veins and are scattered across the page, with a higher concentration in the top-left and bottom-right corners. The main text is centered in the upper half of the page.

Peppermint

Mentha × piperita

Herbal Actions

- Settles the tummy (a carminative)
- Cooling
- Drying

Taste

- Pungent, like a sharp, cool burst of mint
- Sweet, like a tiny bit of honey

Identify by

- Deep green leaves with tiny teeth along the edge
- A stem with a hint of purple
- A cool, minty smell when you crush a leaf



Caution

The strong mint oil is just for grown-ups to use.

Grown-ups: keep peppermint oil off a baby's face and nose.



Calendula, gold and bright
Soothes a scrape and calms the skin
Petals warm as morning light
Mary's gold, soft care within

Calendula

Calendula officinalis

Asteraceae



Calendula

Calendula officinalis

Herbal Actions

- Heals scrapes and calms red, sore skin (a vulnerary, helps wounds mend)
- Cooling
- Moistening

Taste

- Bitter, like dark leafy greens
- Salty, like a little lick of broth

Identify by

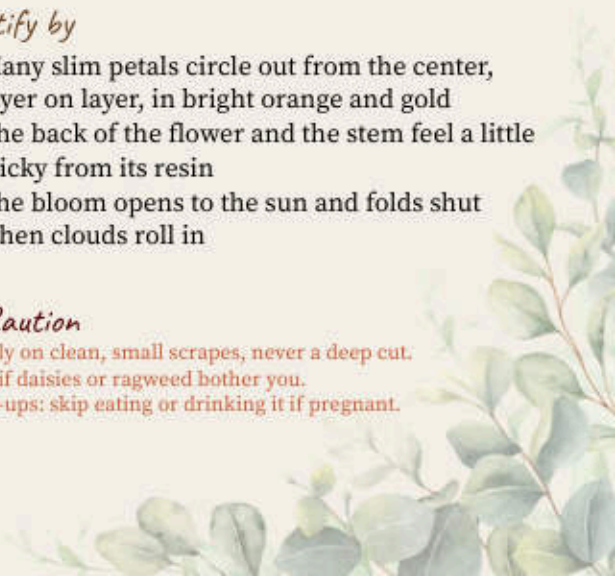
- Many slim petals circle out from the center, layer on layer, in bright orange and gold
- The back of the flower and the stem feel a little sticky from its resin
- The bloom opens to the sun and folds shut when clouds roll in

Caution

Use only on clean, small scrapes; never a deep cut.

Skip it if daisies or ragweed bother you.

Grown-ups: skip eating or drinking it if pregnant.





Plantain grows along the way
Humble weed beneath our feet
Draws the sting and saves the day
God hides helpers small and sweet

Plantain

Plantago major

Plantaginaceae



Plantain

Plantago major

Herbal Actions

- Soothes and draws out a sting (a demulcent and drawing herb)
- Cooling
- Moistening

Taste

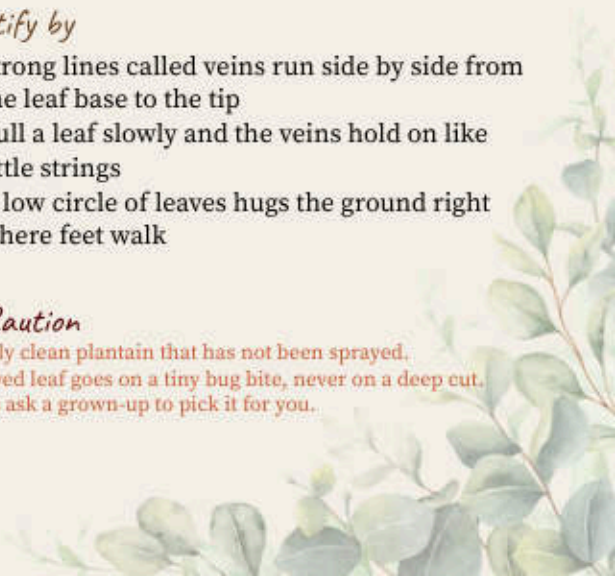
- Bland, like plain lettuce
- Salty, like a tiny sip of broth

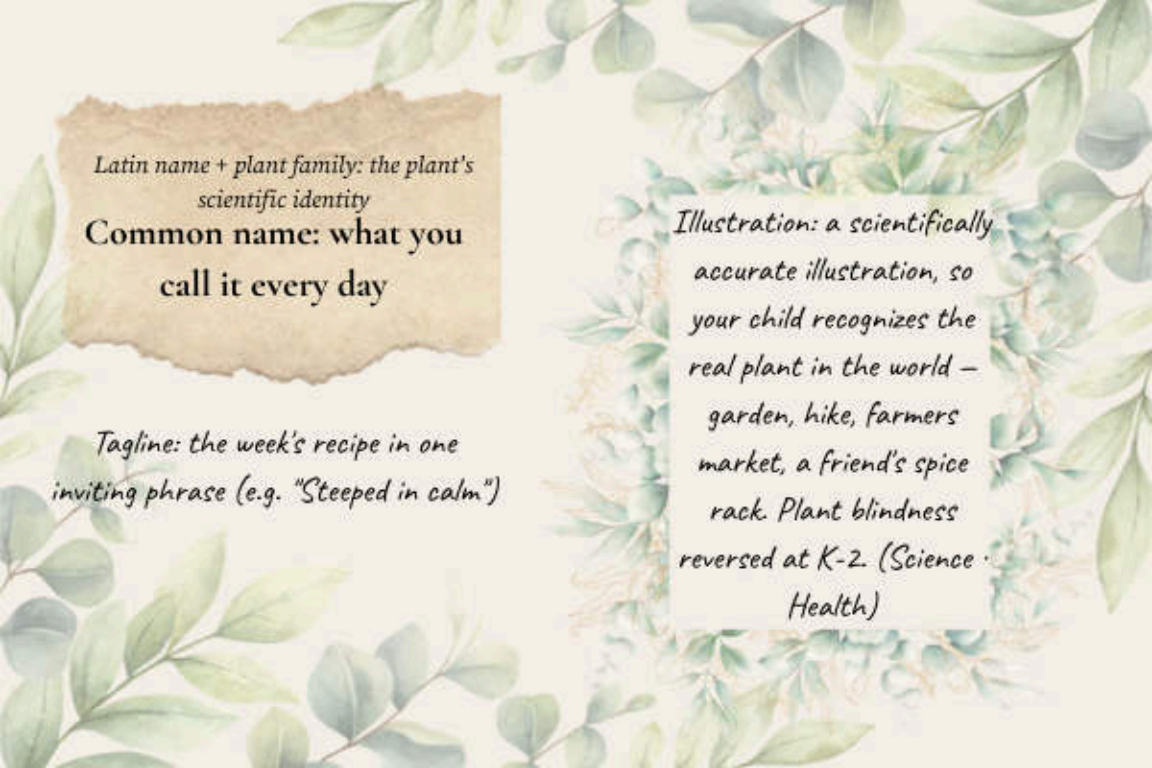
Identify by

- Strong lines called veins run side by side from the leaf base to the tip
- Pull a leaf slowly and the veins hold on like little strings
- A low circle of leaves hugs the ground right where feet walk

Caution

Use only clean plantain that has not been sprayed.
A chewed leaf goes on a tiny bug bite, never on a deep cut.
Always ask a grown-up to pick it for you.





Latin name + plant family: the plant's scientific identity

Common name: what you call it every day

Tagline: the week's recipe in one inviting phrase (e.g. "Steeped in calm")

Illustration: a scientifically accurate illustration, so your child recognizes the real plant in the world – garden, hike, farmers market, a friend's spice rack. Plant blindness reversed at K-2. (Science + Health)

Recipe name: the week's preparation

INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENTS: what you'll need, and how much. Real measurements (tsp, oz, cup) — math and literacy at the kitchen counter. (Math · LA)

METHOD

METHOD: numbered steps your child reads and does with their own hands. By Grade 2, 36 real recipes made. (LA · Science · Health · Math)

Vovó says:

Grandmother's tip in one line — the wisdom the science doesn't capture. (Family · History · LA)

SAFETY:

Honest warnings — hot water, allergies, dosage. Real risk language, even for our youngest. (Science · Health)

SCRIPTURE: a Bible verse (NASB) on every card, anchoring the curriculum's worldview. (Bible / Worldview)

BOOK CHAPTER:VERSE (TRANSLATION)

CHANT POINTER: A CROSS-REFERENCE TO THE WEEK'S CHANT, E.G. "CHANT: LAVENDER (SEE WEEK 01)." 36 CHANTS MEMORIZED. (MUSIC · MEMORY)

Lavandula angustifolia · Lamiaceae

Lavender

Steeped in calm



Lavender Tea

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tsp dried lavender buds
- 8 oz hot water
- A little honey (optional)

METHOD

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried lavender buds into a mug.
2. Have a grown-up pour 8 oz of hot water over the buds.
3. Cover and steep 5 minutes. Count them together.
4. Strain out the buds.
5. Stir in a little honey if you like.
6. Let it cool, then taste.

Vovó says:

Smell the steam first. God gave us the scent of rest so we would remember to be still.

SAFETY:

A little lavender goes far. Smell and touch the dried buds, but never taste lavender oil. It is very strong. The water is hot. Let a grown-up pour, and let the tea cool before you sip.

*I am fearfully and wonderfully made;
wonderful are Your works.*

PSALM 139:14 (NASB)

CHANT: LAVENDER (SEE WEEK 01)

Matricaria chamomilla • Asteraceae

Chamomile (German)

Steeped in golden calm



Chamomile Tea

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tsp dried chamomile flowers
- 8 oz hot water
- A little honey (optional)

METHOD

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried chamomile flowers into a mug.
2. Ask a grown-up to pour 8 oz of hot water over them.
3. Cover and steep for 5 minutes.
4. Strain out the flowers.
5. Add a little honey if you like.
6. Let it cool. Then smell and taste.

Vovó says:

Smell the steam first. It smells like apples. Even the smallest flower was made to bring us peace.

SAFETY:

Grown-ups pour the hot water and let the tea cool before tasting.
Chamomile is a daisy cousin. If anyone sniffles around daisies or ragweed, check with a grown-up first.

I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

GENESIS 1:29 (NASB)

CHANT: CHAMOMILE (SEE WEEK 02)

Melissa officinalis · Lamiaceae

Lemon Balm

Sip a little sunshine



Lemon Balm Cordial

INGREDIENTS

- A small handful of fresh lemon balm leaves
- 2 cups cool water
- 1 to 2 spoons honey
- A squeeze of lemon
- A little ice

METHOD

1. Tear a small handful of fresh lemon balm leaves to bruise them.
2. Put the leaves in a jar with 2 cups of cool water.
3. Stir in 1 to 2 spoons of honey and a squeeze of lemon.
4. Let it sit 10 minutes so the flavor wakes up.
5. Strain the leaves out, pour over a little ice, and sip.

Vovó says:

Rub a leaf and smell the bright lemon, then sip slow. A glad heart is good medicine, and this sweet, cool drink helps it along.

SAFETY:

Lemon balm is friendly and safe.
Honey is never for babies under one year old.

A joyful heart is good medicine.

PROVERBS 17:22 (NASB)

CHANT: LEMON BALM (SEE WEEK 03)

Mentha × piperita · Lamiaceae

Peppermint

A cool cloth of calm



Cooling Peppermint Compress

INGREDIENTS

- 1 Tbsp dried peppermint
- 8 oz hot water

METHOD

1. Measure 1 Tbsp of dried peppermint into a bowl.
2. Ask a grown-up to pour 8 oz of hot water over it. Let it steep 10 minutes.
3. Strain the tea. Let it cool until it is just warm.
4. Dip a clean cloth in the tea and wring it out.
5. Lay the cool cloth on your forehead or arm. Rinse the cloth after.

Vovó says:

Feel the cool cloth on your skin. God made the cool and the warm, and both are a kindness.

SAFETY:

Peppermint is cool and strong. Keep the compress off your eyes and face.
A grown-up pours the hot water. Let the tea cool before it touches skin.
Grown-ups: peppermint essential oil is very strong. Use only the dried leaf here, not the oil.

It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones.

PROVERBS 3:8 (NASB)

CHANT: PEPPERMINT (SEE WEEK 04)

Calendula officinalis · Asteraceae

Calendula

Golden petals, gentle care



Calendula Skin Dressing

INGREDIENTS

- 1 Tbsp dried calendula petals
- 8 oz hot water
- 1 clean cloth or gauze

METHOD

1. Measure 1 Tbsp of dried calendula petals into a bowl.
2. Ask a grown-up to pour 8 oz of hot water over the petals. Let it steep 10 minutes.
3. Strain out the petals. Let the tea cool until it is just warm, not hot.
4. Soak a clean cloth or gauze in the warm tea, then wring it out.
5. Lay it gently on clean skin for a few minutes.

Vovó says:

Press the warm cloth on softly. The golden petals soothe the skin, and gentle hands soothe the heart.

SAFETY:

The water is hot. Let a grown-up pour, and cool the tea until just warm before it touches skin. Use it only on clean, small scrapes, never a deep cut. Check first if daisies or ragweed bother you.

He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.

PSALM 147:3 (NASB)

CHANT: CALENDULA (SEE WEEK 05)

Plantago major · Plantaginaceae

Plantain

Mashed leaf, happy skin



Plantain Poultice

INGREDIENTS

- 1 fresh, clean plantain leaf

METHOD

1. Pick and rinse a fresh, clean plantain leaf.
2. Mash it in a bowl until juicy. A grown-up helps.
3. Lay the green mash on a bug bite or sting.
4. Hold it on with a clean cloth for a few minutes.
5. Wipe clean when done. Never save it.

Vovó says:

*Feel the cool green mash on your skin.
God hides His best gifts in humble
places, so look down, meu amor.*

SAFETY:

Use only clean, unsprayed plantain. Ask a grown-up to pick it.
A poultice goes on tiny bites, never a deep cut.

*Blessed are the gentle, for they shall
inherit the earth.*

MATTHEW 5:5 (NASB)

CHANT: PLANTAIN (SEE WEEK 06)

BODY

BODY CARD – a question about how your body works, feels, or signals. Read at the table. Listen for what your child notices about their own body. (Subjects: Health · Science)

WK 0 EXPLAINER · HOW TO USE THE
DECK

BODY

Each card carries TWO discussion questions. Q1 = something your child can notice in their own body right now. No right answer — listen first, then share yours.

Q2 = same theme, deeper. Introduces a real anatomy or herb word. Family conversations strengthen when both sides risk an answer.

Every BODY back card carries a body-system note — connects the question to real anatomy + the week's herb. Quiet teaching while you talk.

Every card cross-references the week's unit + herb. Pull the card Sunday at dinner — the herb context already sits in your kitchen.

FAITH

FAITH CARD – a question that opens scripture, the character of God, or worldview. Designed for family discussion, not catechism.

(Subjects: Bible/Worldview · Family)

WK 0 EXPLAINER · FAITH CATEGORY

FAITH

Q1 = scripture-anchored question.
Invites the child into the Word + the family's own answers. The family table is a place where faith is formed in conversation, not lectured.

Q2 = applies the same theme to your child's life or the week's herb. Faith braided with the everyday.

Every FAITH back card carries a NASB scripture passage. Anchors the conversation in the Word, not our opinions.

Same cross-reference pattern = each card lives inside the week's curriculum unit + herb context.

FAMILY

FAMILY CARD – a question that invites stories from your home, your lineage, your kitchen. The point isn't the answer – it's the storytelling. (Subjects: Family · History · LA)

WK 0 EXPLAINER · FAMILY CATEGORY

FAMILY

Q1 = your child's experience of family. What they've heard, learned, witnessed at your table.

Q2 = invites a grandparent's, aunt's, parent's experience. Multi-generational conversation. Families are strengthened when stories cross generations.

Every FAMILY back card carries a Vovó saying — grandmother voice from the story family. Models lineage wisdom carried in one short observation.

Each FAMILY card sits inside the week's unit. Pull at dinner; let the conversation wander.

WONDER

WONDER CARD – a question with no right answer. Pure imagination, pattern-noticing, awe. The questions you wish someone had asked you as a child. (Subjects: Science · LA · Bible/Worldview)

WR 0 EXPLAINER · WONDER CATEGORY

WONDER

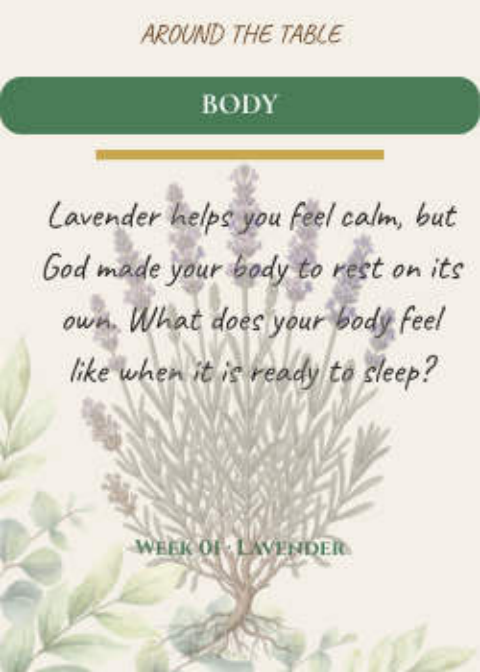
Q1 = observation-style wonder.
Notices a pattern in the world that
points to design.

Q2 = imagination-style wonder. Open-
ended. Children answer these in
ways adults forgot how.

*Every WONDER back card ends with a
sensory-imagination prompt. Eyes closed.
Picture. Smell. Hear. Body brought into
the question.*

*Same cross-reference. Wonder lives inside the week's content,
not separate from it.*

BODY



Lavender helps you feel calm, but God made your body to rest on its own. What does your body feel like when it is ready to sleep?

WEEK OF LAVENDER

BODY

1. When the end of a long day comes, what does your sleepy body start to feel like?
2. Lavender smells RELAXING, which means calm and quiet. God made your body to rest and mend by itself. Why is a calm scent a kind helper?

Design • Lavender, for calm and the senses

Connected to: In the Garden God Made • Week 01

AROUND THE TABLE

FAITH

*What do you think "wonderfully
made" says about you?*

WEEK OF LAVENDER



FAITH

1. The verse says you are wonderfully made. Who made every little part of you so carefully?
2. God made your body to heal and rest all on its own. What is one amazing thing your body does that you never have to think about?

*"I am fearfully and wonderfully made;
wonderful are Your works." – Psalm
139:14 (NASB)*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 01

AROUND THE TABLE

FAMILY

*What helps you feel calm and
safe at the end of a day?*

WEEK OF LAVENDER



FAMILY

1. Tell about a time you felt happy and peaceful. What was happening then?
2. Grown-up, share a calm, cozy place from when you were little. How did it feel to be there, and who was with you?

Vovó says: God gave us the scent of rest so we would remember to be still.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 01

WONDER

*What if Bear the dog smelled like
sleepy lavender after a bath?*

WEEK OF LAVENDER



WONDER

1. God tucked a calming scent in one tiny flower. What does that make you wonder about Him?
2. Lavender made its calming smell long before anyone knew why. What other gifts do you think God hid in the garden, waiting for us to find?

Close your eyes. Breathe in soft lavender on a warm, sunny hill. Feel your shoulders slow and rest.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 01

BODY



*Chamomile soothes a sore spot,
but God made your skin to mend
itself. What happens to a little
scrape over the next few days?*

WEEK 02 · CHAMOMILE

BODY

1. Find a spot where you once had a scrape. Is the skin smooth now? Who fixed it for you?
2. Chamomile is a NERVINE, a gentle calmer. God made a calm body mend best. How might rest help a scrape heal?

Design - Chamomile, for soothed skin and calm

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 02

FAITH



*In Genesis 1:29 God gives us
every plant. Why give us so
many?*

WEEK 02 · CHAMOMILE

FAITH

1. God said the plants are "for you."
How does it feel that He made
chamomile with you in mind?

2. God built healing into your skin
AND tucked calm into a tiny flower.
What does that show about how He
loves you?

*"I have given you every plant yielding
seed; it shall be food for you." - Genesis
1:29 (NASB)*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 02

EDEN'S TABLE

AROUND THE TABLE

FAMILY

*Who in our family is good at
helping someone feel calm again?*

WEEK 02 · CHAMOMILE

FAMILY

1. When you feel hurt or upset, what helps you feel safe and calm again?
2. Grown-up, share a time you were scared or hurt as a kid, and someone's gentle care helped you feel safe again.

Vovó says: Even the smallest flower was made to bring us peace.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 02

WONDER

*What if chamomile tea was so
calming it made your shoes nap?*

WEEK 02 · CHAMOMILE

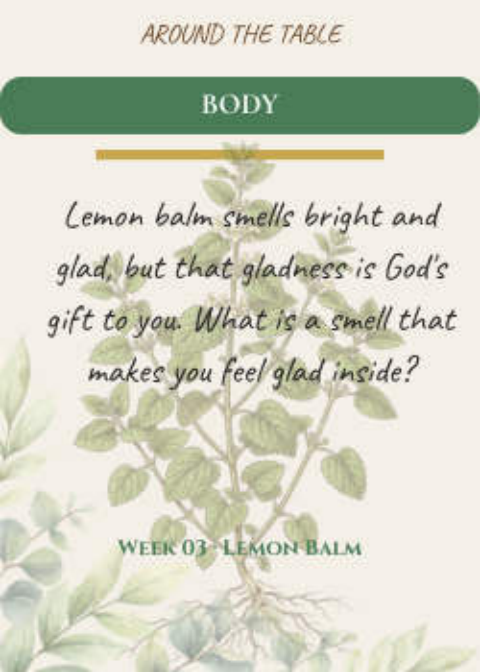
WONDER

1. A flower behind your thumb can calm a whole person. Why does God make big gifts so small?
2. God taught your skin to close a cut with nobody telling it how. If your body could whisper one thank-you to God, what would it say?

Close your eyes. Smell warm chamomile tea, like sweet apples. Feel it calm you, the way God made you to mend.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 02

BODY



Lemon balm smells bright and glad, but that gladness is God's gift to you. What is a smell that makes you feel glad inside?

WEEK 03 · LEMON BALM

BODY

1. Think of a time your heart felt heavy. What helped it feel lighter again?

2. UPLIFTING means lifting a heavy heart up. God made you to feel ups and downs, and gave lemon balm a bright scent to cheer you.

*Design · Lemon Balm, for bright spirits
and calm*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made · Week 03

FAITH

What do you think "a joyful heart is good medicine" means?

WEEK 03 • LEMON BALM

FAITH

1. Proverbs 17:22 says gladness can heal like medicine. Where does real gladness come from?
2. God made lemon balm bright AND made your heart to feel glad. The herb cheers a bit, but lasting joy is His. What gladdens you in Him?

*"A joyful heart is good medicine." -
Proverbs 17:22 (NASB)*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 03

AROUND THE TABLE

FAMILY

*What is one little thing that
always makes you feel cheerful?*

WEEK 03 • LEMON BALM

FAMILY

1. Can you tell us about a time your heart felt heavy, and who or what helped lift it?
2. Grown-up, share a time you felt low and something gentle cheered you. Who or what did God use to lift your heart?

*Vovó says: A glad heart is good medicine –
and God grows it in the garden.*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 03

AROUND THE TABLE

WONDER

*Why do you think bees love lemon
balm so much?*

WEEK 03 · LEMON BALM

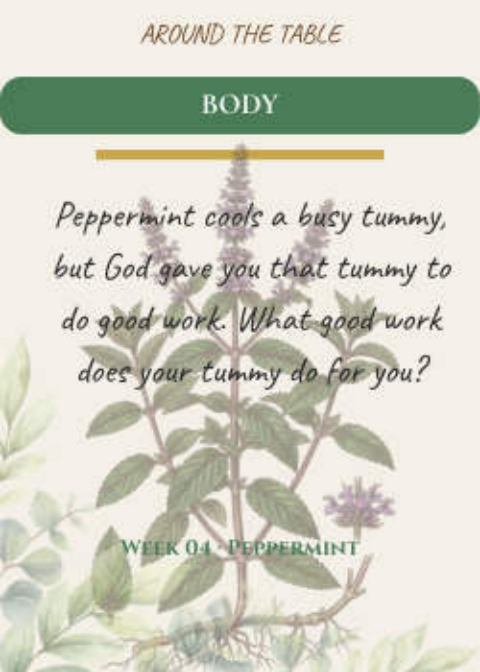
WONDER

1. God made the bee and balm to delight in each other. What does that show about how God gives?
2. The Greeks named it Melissa, their word for honeybee. What if a buzzing bee tried to use a lemon balm leaf as its tiny pillow and snored?

Close your eyes. You are a bee in a sunny Greek garden, nose deep in a bright lemony leaf, wings warm.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 03

BODY



*Peppermint cools a busy tummy,
but God gave you that tummy to
do good work. What good work
does your tummy do for you?*

WEEK 04 · PEPPERMINT

BODY

1. Have you ever felt your tummy gurgle or grumble? What do you think it is busy doing?
2. CARMINATIVE means an herb that calms a busy tummy. Why is it kind that God made peppermint cool to settle the tummy He gave you?

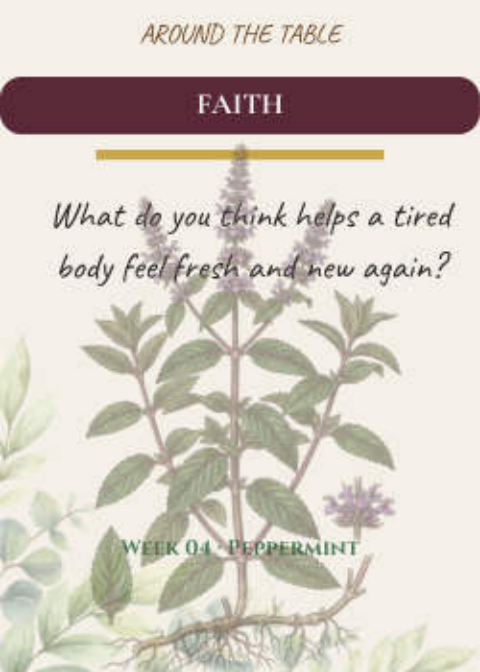
*Design · Peppermint, for a happy tummy
and cooling*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made · Week 04

FAITH

*What do you think helps a tired
body feel fresh and new again?*

WEEK 04 · PEPPERMINT

A detailed botanical illustration of a peppermint plant. The plant features several upright, reddish-brown stems with opposite, green, serrated leaves. At the top of the stems are dense, elongated spikes of small purple flowers. The base of the plant shows a woody, brown root system with some smaller, emerging stems. The background is a soft, light green wash.

FAITH

1. Proverbs 3:8 says good things bring healing. What do you think helps a scrape heal?
2. God tucked healing into cool peppermint and into your own mending body. What does that show you about how much He cares for you?

"It will be healing to your body and refreshment to your bones." - Proverbs 3:8 (NASB)

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 04

AROUND THE TABLE

FAMILY

*Who has taught you something
you love? How did they teach you?*

WEEK 04 · PEPPERMINT

A detailed botanical illustration of a peppermint plant. The plant features several upright, reddish-brown stems with opposite, green, serrated leaves. At the top of the stems are dense, elongated spikes of small purple flowers. The base of the plant shows a woody, brown root system with some smaller, emerging stems.

FAMILY

1. What is one thing a grown-up in our family has taught you how to do?

2. Grown-up: tell about an older person who taught you something dear. What did you learn from watching their hands that you still carry?

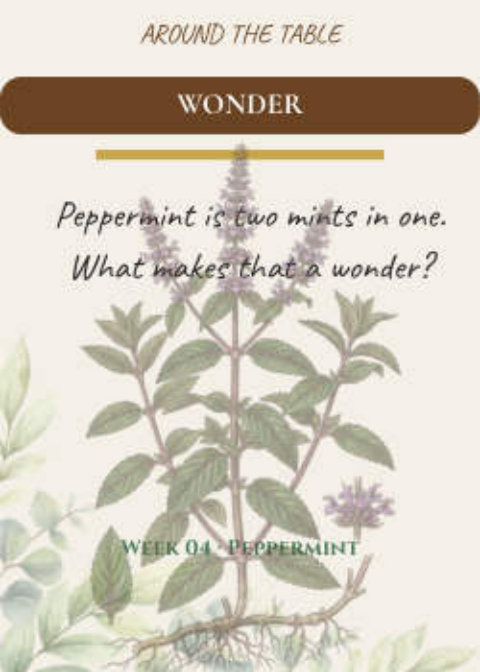
Vovó says: God made the cool and the warm, and both are a kindness.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 04

WONDER

*Peppermint is two mints in one.
What makes that a wonder?*

WEEK 04 · PEPPERMINT

A detailed botanical illustration of a peppermint plant. The plant features several upright, reddish-brown stems with opposite, green, serrated leaves. At the top of the stems are dense, elongated spikes of small, purple flowers. The base of the plant shows a woody, brown root system with some smaller, emerging stems. The background is a soft, light green wash.

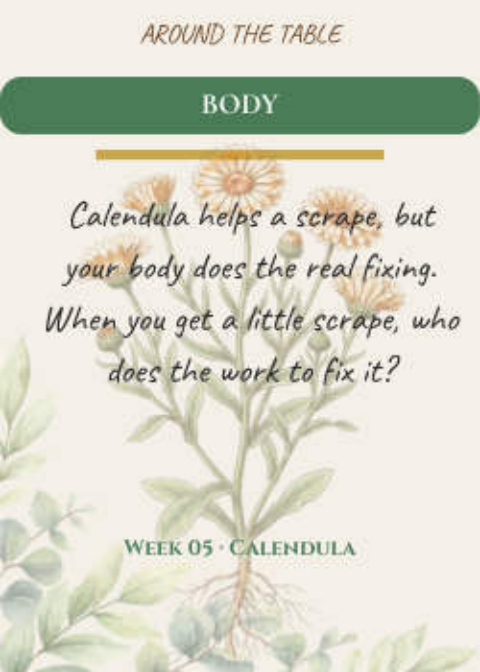
WONDER

1. God blended two mints to make peppermint's cool taste. What makes you wonder?
2. What if peppermint grew tall as a tree and a whole town napped in its cool, minty shade? Mitcham loved mint so much they were famous for it instead of gold!

Close your eyes. You walk through cool green mint fields. The sweet smell drifts for miles on the breeze.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 04

BODY



*Calendula helps a scrape, but
your body does the real fixing.
When you get a little scrape, who
does the work to fix it?*

WEEK 05 • CALENDULA

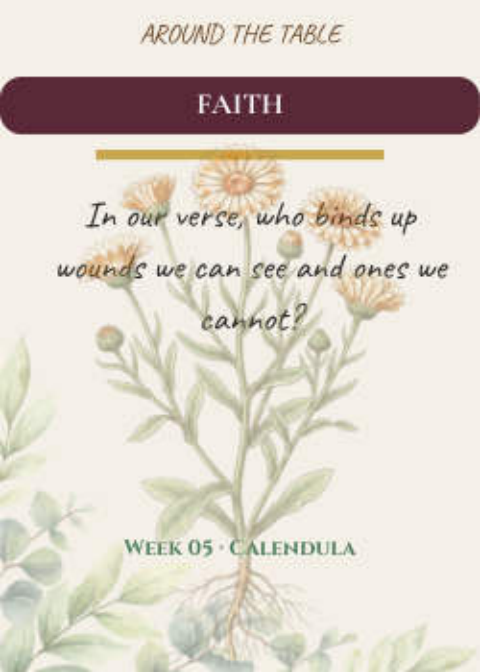
BODY

1. When a scrape heals on its own, what do you think is happening under there?
2. VULNERARY means a plant that helps skin mend. Calendula is one. How does it help your skin do the healing God already built it to do?

Design - Calendula, for the skin and gentle care

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 05

FAITH



*In our verse, who binds up
wounds we can see and ones we
cannot?*

WEEK 05 • CALENDULA

FAITH

1. Psalm 147:3 says God heals and binds up wounds. What kinds of hurts can He reach?

2. A scrape needs a bandage, but a sad heart needs God. How does calendula on your skin remind you He cares all the way through?

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds," - Psalm 147:3 (NASB)

Connected to In the Garden God Made - Week 03

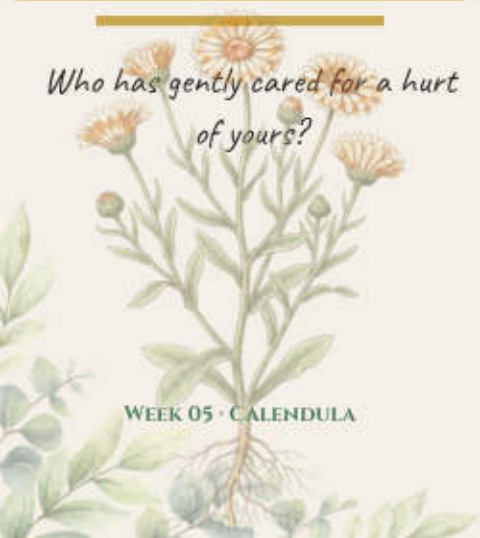
EDEN'S TABLE

AROUND THE TABLE

FAMILY

*Who has gently cared for a hurt
of yours?*

WEEK 05 • CALENDULA



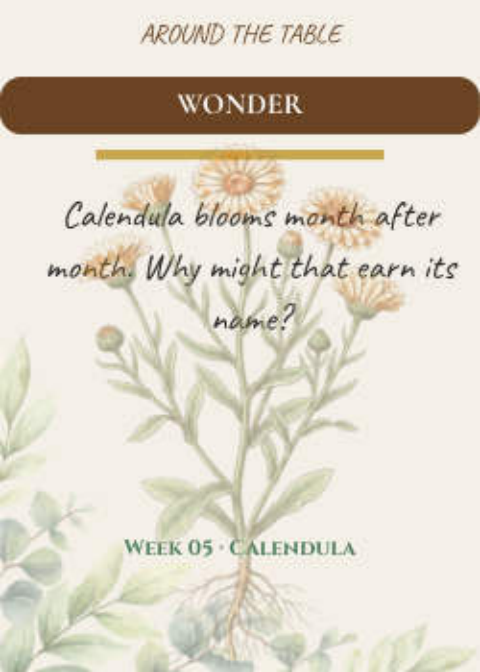
FAMILY

1. Tell about a scrape or bump you had. Who helped you, and how did it feel to be cared for?
2. Grown-up, share a time you were hurting, maybe inside, and someone tended you. Who bound up that wound for you?

Vovó says: The same hands that mend our skin are mending our hearts.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 05

WONDER



Calendula blooms month after month. Why might that earn its name?

WEEK 05 • CALENDULA

WONDER

1. One golden flower makes seeds
AND soothes skin. What does one
plant doing two jobs show you?

2. Long ago monks called calendula
Mary's gold, which softened into
marigold. What if its petals were real
gold coins? What silly thing would
you buy?

*Close your eyes. You walk through a grey
stone garden warmed by rows of glowing
gold flowers.*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 05

BODY

Plantain soothes an itchy bite,
but God gave you skin to cover
you. Your skin covers you
everywhere. What good does it
do?

WEEK 06 · PLANTAIN

BODY

1. Press your finger soft on your arm, then let go. Watch your skin spring right back!
2. Plantain has a DRAWING action, gently pulling hurt out of skin. How does your skin mend a small scrape on its own?

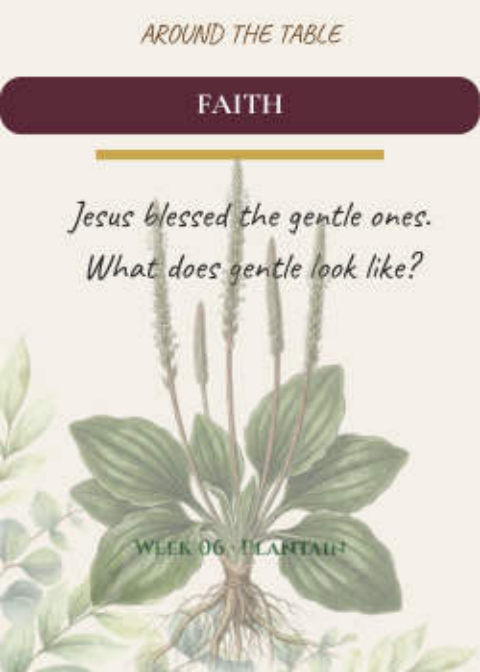
Design · Plantain, for resilient skin

Connected to: In the Garden God Made · Week 05

FAITH

*Jesus blessed the gentle ones.
What does gentle look like?*

WEEK 06 • PLANTAIN



FAITH

1. Matthew 5:5 says the gentle are blessed. Who is someone gentle with you?

2. Plantain is a humble weed people walk past, yet God hid a gift in it. How could God use small, gentle you?

"Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth." – Matthew 5:5 (NASB)

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 00

EDEN'S TABLE

FAMILY

*When you have a little hurt, who
do you want close by?*

WEEK 06 · PLANTAIN

A detailed botanical illustration of a plantain (Plantago major). The plant features a central rosette of broad, oval-shaped green leaves with prominent veins. Several upright, reddish-brown stems rise from the center, each topped with a dense, elongated spike of tiny flowers. The root system is visible at the base, showing a network of fibrous roots. The background is a soft, light green wash.

FAMILY

1. Tell about a time you were hurt or sad and someone made it feel better.
2. Grown-up, share a time someone gentle cared for you when you were small or hurting, and how it felt.

Vovó says: God hides His best gifts in humble places – look down, meu amor.

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 05

WONDER

Plantain grows right on the paths where we walk. Why there?

WEEK 06 · PLANTAIN

A detailed botanical illustration of a plantain plant. The plant has a central rosette of broad, green leaves with prominent veins. Several upright stems rise from the center, each topped with a long, cylindrical seed head. The root system is shown at the base, with numerous fibrous roots extending downwards. The background is a light, textured wash of green and yellow, suggesting a natural setting.

WONDER

1. God put a helper weed along busy roads. What does that show about how He plans things?
2. Long ago people called plantain waybread for the ways it sprang up along. What if a plant grew you a tiny sandwich when you walked by? What would be inside?

*Close your eyes. You kneel by a dusty path.
Feel a broad, cool plantain leaf, soft
against your skin.*

Connected to: In the Garden God Made - Week 05